STUDENTS' BOOKLET · SEMESTER 1

TECHNICAL TRANSLATION

Chapter 1: Media and Politics Headlines

ترجمة العناوين والأخبار السياسية

Arabic → English 70 % · English → Arabic 30 %

Headlines · Bulletins · Diplomacy · Crises

HEADLINES | BULLETINS | DIPLOMACY | CRISES

LEVEL	Third-year undergraduate (L3)
INSTITUTION	Faculty of Arts and Humanities of Sousse · University of Sousse
ACADEMIC YEAR	2026–2027 · Fall semester

Name: …… Group: ……

Instructor: ……

Contents and Course Calendar

Semester 1 · One chapter, twelve lectures, one workflow

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How to use this booklet

THEORY	Short lecture notes with the key ideas of each lecture.
TOOLKIT	Contrastive tables with ready-to-use English–Arabic solutions.
WARM-UP	Questions to think about and answer in the spaces provided.
HEADLINES	A headline workshop in every lecture: four Arabic and two English headlines to translate.
MEDIA WATCH	A short task that sends you to real Arabic and English channels to compare their coverage.
TEXT A / B	Source texts in each direction (Arabic → English and English → Arabic), with a terminology bank, "watch out" points and writing lines.
PRACTICE	Two shorter extra texts per lecture (one in each direction) for independent practice.
LOG	Your translator's log: reflect, justify, record terms.

All source texts in this chapter were written for classroom use. Texts about real events are based on publicly reported facts (2025–2026) and are written in the style of known news genres; they are not reproduced from any broadcaster. Texts marked fictional are invented. Facts were checked in October 2026: verify them against current sources before reusing them.

Course Description

Technical Translation · L3 · Semester 1 (Fall 2026–2027) · Media and Political Translation

Course	Technical Translation (Arabic–English–Arabic) · Semester 1 chapter: Media and Politics Headlines
Level	Third-year undergraduate (L3)
Institution	Faculty of Arts and Humanities of Sousse, University of Sousse
Term	Fall semester, academic year 2026–2027
Format	12 weekly lectures of 1 h 30 (mini-lecture and translation workshop), followed by revision and examination
Working languages	Modern Standard Arabic and standard English (about 70 % Arabic → English, 30 % English → Arabic)
Prerequisites	Introduction to Translation Studies; advanced English; advanced Arabic writing
Instructor	……

Overview

This semester the Technical Translation course concentrates on one specialised field: **media and political translation**. Every day, Arabic and English newsrooms translate headlines, agency dispatches, bulletins, official statements and editorials about political events, and graduates of English Studies are regularly employed to do this work. The chapter *Media and Politics Headlines* trains you to translate these texts accurately, quickly and responsibly.

The texts follow the coverage of political events and incidents across the globe in 2024–2026, with a deliberate balance of regions: the **Arab world and the Maghreb** (Syria, Lebanon, Iraq, Gaza, Sudan, Algeria, Egypt, Western Sahara), **Europe and the war in Ukraine** (NATO, the EU, elections in Germany, the Netherlands and Poland, the drone incursion into Poland, peace talks), and **global issues** (climate, trade and tariffs, pandemic preparedness, artificial intelligence, international law). One lecture is a case study of the Iran–United States crisis. All source texts are written in **Modern Standard Arabic** and **standard English**.

In line with the needs of the profession in Tunisia and the region, about **70 %** of the translation work is from **Arabic into English** and **30 %** from **English into Arabic**. The approach is functionalist and genre-based (Nord 1997; Bielsa & Bassnett 2009): every translation starts from a brief, and every decision about headlines, attribution, reporting verbs and loaded vocabulary is justified in a translator's log.

Aims

- Introduce the theory of news and political translation, including transediting, framing and ideology.
- Develop the ability to translate headlines, leads, bulletins, statements and editorials in both directions.
- Build English–Arabic terminology for diplomacy, conflict, elections, economics and humanitarian affairs.
- Train accuracy in attribution, figures, names and reporting verbs under realistic time constraints.
- Encourage critical, ethical and well-informed reading of Arabic and English media coverage of world events.

Learning outcomes

By the end of the course you will be able to:

1. Explain news translation as transediting and describe the conventions of headlines, leads and bulletins in Arabic and English.
2. Translate political news texts from Modern Standard Arabic into English accurately and idiomatically.
3. Translate English news texts into Modern Standard Arabic using the conventions of Arabic news writing.
4. Use reliable English–Arabic terminology for diplomacy, conflict, the economy, elections and humanitarian affairs.
5. Preserve attribution, modality, figures and stance, and apply a consistent editorial line to loaded vocabulary.
6. Condense, reorder and adapt news items for a given medium, audience and length.
7. Revise translations and justify decisions in a written commentary and a translator's log.

Pedagogical Framework

How the course teaches and how you will learn

The course follows a functionalist, genre-based and task-oriented approach to translator training. Your development is understood as the growth of translation competence: bilingual and extra-linguistic knowledge, knowledge about translation, instrumental skills (research, terminology, tools) and strategic skills for solving problems (PACTE 2003).

1. Purpose before form

Every task starts with a brief: who reads the translation, for what? Strategies follow from purpose (skopos), not from habit.

2. Genre and text type

Each lecture is anchored in real genres. You learn what a leaflet, a clause or a news lead looks like in both languages.

3. Learning by translating

Task-based and process-oriented: analyse, research, draft, revise and reflect on every text.

4. Contrastive, in two directions

English→Arabic and Arabic→English tasks in every lecture reveal how the two languages organise information differently.

5. Research, terminology and technology

You build a termbase, use parallel texts and authoritative sources, and learn to evaluate CAT and machine-translation tools.

6. Reflective and ethical practice

Logs, peer review and discussion develop judgement; accuracy, confidentiality and responsibility are part of every lecture.

Anatomy of a lecture (90 minutes)

Phase	Time	In this booklet	What you do
Warm-up	10 min	Think and discuss	Activate what you know; share experiences.
Mini-lecture	25 min	Lecture notes and Toolkit	Key concepts, contrasts and ready-to-use solutions.
Analysis	10 min	Before you translate	Function, readers, problems and terms.
Workshop	35 min	Texts A and B	Translate in both directions; compare in pairs.
Debrief	10 min	Translator's log	Justify choices and record lessons and terms.

Assessment (proposed)

Component	Weight	Description
Continuous assessment	40 %	Portfolio of revised translations, termbase and translator's log (20 %); in-class translation test after Lecture 8 (20 %).
Final examination	60 %	Two-hour written exam: one English→Arabic and one Arabic→English translation with brief and a short commentary on key decisions.

Weights and formats can be adjusted to departmental regulations.

The Translator's Workflow

One method for every text in this course

1	2	3	4	5	6
PREPARE	**ANALYSE**	**RESEARCH**	**DRAFT**	**REVISE**	**REFLECT**
What is the brief?	Who, why, what genre?	Which terms and parallel texts?	Meaning first, then form.	Check against the source and the brief.	What did I learn?

Self-revision checklist

- ☐ **Meaning:** nothing added, omitted or distorted; numbers, units, negations and names checked.
- ☐ **Terminology:** each concept has one term; choices come from reliable sources and are recorded in the termbase.
- ☐ **Language:** grammar, spelling, punctuation and style are natural in the target language.
- ☐ **Genre and function:** the text looks and sounds like its target genre and fits the brief.
- ☐ **Form:** layout, numbering, headings, directionality (RTL/LTR) and symbols are correct.

Error categories used in feedback and marking

Category	Description	Example
Mistranslation	Meaning wrongly transferred.	*stress* → ضغط in engineering
Omission / addition	Content lost or invented.	Dropping *preferably* in a dose instruction
Terminology	Wrong or inconsistent term.	حاسوب and كمبيوتر in one manual
Language	Grammar, spelling, syntax, calques.	Overuse of «يتم»; "pressure of blood"
Register / genre	Style unsuited to the text type.	Colloquial wording in a contract
Form	Punctuation, numbers, layout, RTL issues.	10.000 د.ت read as ten dinars

Translation brief: quick template

Client and purpose	
Readers	
Medium and place	
Deadline and urgency	
Function	
Strategy	

Chapter 1 · Media and Politics Headlines

Headlines, bulletins and the coverage of political crises · Weeks 1–12

Political news is one of the most translated kinds of text in the world, and one of the most sensitive. A single headline can frame an event; a single reporting verb can turn a statement into an accusation; a single wrong figure can mislead millions of readers. This chapter treats news translation as a **specialised and technical** activity: it has its own genres, its own terminology and its own professional standards.

Each lecture follows the same structure as the rest of the booklet: lecture notes, a contrastive toolkit, a warm-up, a **headline workshop**, two main texts with terminology banks and "watch out" points, two shorter practice texts, a **media watch** task and a translator's log. The last lecture is a newsroom simulation in which you translate and transedit a complete bulletin. The headline workshops add 72 headlines to translate, in the same proportion: four from Arabic and two from English in each lecture.

A NOTE ON SOURCES, FACTS AND SENSITIVITY

The events in this chapter involve war, loss of life and deep political disagreement. The texts are written to be neutral and to keep every claim attributed to its source. In class, we analyse how media language works; we do not take sides. Names such as "the Gulf", "the Persian Gulf" or "the Arabian Gulf", and words such as «استشهد» or «قُتل», are discussed as translation problems: the translator follows the brief and the client's style guide and explains the choice in the log.

Chapter at a glance

Wk	Lecture	Events and texts	AR→EN	EN→AR
1	Political headlines	Syria sanctions lifted · NATO summit · Gaza ceasefire · COP30	3	1
2	The news bulletin	New pope elected · WHO pandemic agreement · Lebanon's president · Grand Egyptian Museum	2	2
3	Diplomacy and negotiations	Russia–Ukraine talks in Istanbul · EU–US trade deal · al-Sharaa at the White House · Geneva talks	3	1
4	Reporting conflict: Iran–US case study	June 2025 strikes · February 2026 strikes · casualty figures · new doctrine	3	1
5	Trade, energy and the economy	US tariffs · gold above $4,000 · Suez Canal revenues · COP30 finance	3	1
6	International organisations	Resolution 2803 · draft resolution (fictional) · Western Sahara · ICJ climate opinion	3	1
7	Quotations and stance	Drones over Poland · Pope Leo's first address · Sansal pardon · G20 statements	2	2
8	Elections	Iraq · the Netherlands · Germany · Poland	3	1
9	Humanitarian crises	El Fasher · famine in Gaza · Valencia floods · Syrian returns	3	1
10	Summits	Sharm el-Sheikh · Alaska · AI Action Summit, Paris · Doha	3	1
11	Editorials and analysis	Editorial on drought · EU AI Act explainer · misinformation · energy importers	3	1
12	Newsroom simulation	Weekend bulletin (G20, COP30, Geneva, papal visit) · Syria timeline	1	1
	Total	**46 texts** (plus 72 headlines in the same proportion)	**32 · 70 %**	**14 · 30 %**

LECTURE

01

WEEK 1

CHAPTER 1 · MEDIA AND POLITICS HEADLINES

Political Headlines: Grammar and Framing

How English and Arabic headlines compress, frame and attract

By the end of this lecture you will be able to:

- Describe the grammar of English headlinese and of Arabic news headlines.
- Translate headlines in both directions without calquing the source structure.
- Recognise how lexical choice frames a political event.
- Write target headlines that respect length, register and the outlet's style.

Lecture notes

1. The headline as a mini-text

A headline is the most read and most rewritten part of a news story. It has two functions: to **summarise** the event and to **attract** the reader (Bell 1991). It works together with the strapline, the lead and, on television, the anchor's cue. In translation, a headline is almost never translated word for word: it is **re-written** for a new readership, which is why news translation is described as transediting (Stetting 1989; Bielsa & Bassnett 2009).

2. English headlinese

- **Present simple for past events:** *EU, US strike trade deal*.
- **To-infinitive for the future:** *Talks to resume next week*; **past participle for the passive:** *Writer pardoned after German appeal*.
- **Dropped articles and auxiliaries**, short 'headline words' (*bid*, *row*, *curb*, *vow*, *probe*, *deal*) and noun stacks (*Syria sanctions relief plan*).
- **Colon or quotation marks for attribution:** *Tusk: Poland 'closest to open conflict' since WWII*.

3. Arabic news headlines

- **Nominal headlines** built on a verbal noun: «استئناف المحادثات بين موسكو وكييف».
- **Verbal headlines in the present tense** with the subject first: «الاتحاد الأوروبي والولايات المتحدة يبرمان اتفاقًا تجاريًا».
- Articles and full grammar are **kept**; do not imitate English noun stacks («خطة تخفيف عقوبات سوريا» is awkward; prefer «خطة لتخفيف العقوبات عن سوريا»).
- Attribution with a colon is common in both languages: «توسك: ...»، «مصادر: ...».

4. Framing and neutrality

Lexical choices frame events: *strike*, *attack* or *aggression* («ضربة»، «هجوم»، «عدوان»); *government* or *regime* («حكومة»، «نظام»); *Western Sahara*, «الصحراء الغربية» or «الصحراء المغربية»; *the Gulf*, *Persian Gulf* or *Arabian Gulf*. Different outlets make different choices for editorial reasons (van Dijk 1988; Baker 2006). The translator follows the **client's style guide and brief**, does not add or remove stance, and records sensitive choices in the log.

Toolkit: headline structures in English and Arabic

English	Arabic	Note
EU, US strike trade deal	الاتحاد الأوروبي والولايات المتحدة يبرمان اتفاقًا تجاريًا	Present simple for a past event
Talks to resume next week	استئناف المحادثات الأسبوع المقبل	To-infinitive → verbal noun
Writer pardoned after German appeal	العفو عن كاتب إثر مناشدة ألمانية	Passive participle → verbal noun
Gold tops $4,000 as investors seek safety	الذهب يتجاوز 4000 دولار مع إقبال المستثمرين على الملاذات الآمنة	as = مع / في ظل
Tusk: Poland ‘closest to open conflict’ since WWII	توسك: بولندا «أقرب ما تكون إلى نزاع مفتوح» منذ الحرب العالمية الثانية	Colon attribution
UN chief urges restraint	الأمين العام للأمم المتحدة يدعو إلى ضبط النفس	Headline word → full form

Warm-up: think and discuss

1 Compare today’s top political headline on an Arabic and an English news website. Which grammatical pattern does each use?

2 Is anything lost when an English headline drops articles and verbs? Does an Arabic headline need to do the same?

3 Which words in a political headline can reveal the stance of the outlet?

Headline workshop

Translate each headline into the other language. Respect the headline conventions of the target language (maximum 10 words).

#	Source headline	Your translation
1	ترامب يعلن من الرياض رفع العقوبات عن سوريا	
2	انتخاب جوزيف عون رئيسًا للبنان بعد أكثر من عامين من الشغور	
3	الرئيس الجزائري يعفو عن الكاتب بوعلام صنصال	
4	افتتاح المتحف المصري الكبير قرب أهرامات الجيزة	
5	NATO allies agree 5% defence spending target	

#	Source headline	Your translation
6	Pope Leo XIV: ‘Peace be with you all’	

MEDIA WATCH

Choose one political story covered today by an Arabic and an English channel of the same network (for example Al Jazeera and Al Jazeera English, or BBC Arabic and BBC News). Copy both headlines into your log and compare their grammar, length and word choice.

TEXT A

Arabic → English · Media and Politics · Agency news report (sanctions)

الرياض – أعلن الرئيس الأمريكي دونالد ترامب يوم الثالث عشر من مايو/أيار 2025، خلال منتدى للاستثمار في العاصمة السعودية، أنه سيأمر برفع العقوبات المفروضة على سوريا، «لمنحها فرصة لتحقيق العظمة»، في تحوّل لافت في السياسة الأمريكية بعد أشهر من سقوط نظام بشار الأسد في ديسمبر/كانون الأول 2024.

وفي اليوم التالي، التقى ترامب الرئيس السوري الانتقالي أحمد الشرع في الرياض، في أول لقاء من نوعه بين رئيسَي البلدين منذ ربع قرن. ورحّبت دمشق وعواصم عربية عدة بالقرار، الذي قال ترامب إنه اتخذه بطلب من وليّ العهد السعودي الأمير محمد بن سلمان.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of an Arabic news agency dispatch, based on publicly reported events (May 2025). Not a broadcaster’s script; details simplified for training.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

- رفع العقوبات = lifting of sanctions
- منتدى للاستثمار = investment forum
- سقوط النظام = fall of the regime / government
- الرئيس الانتقالي = interim president
- بطلب من = at the request of

WATCH OUT

- «لمنحها فرصة لتحقيق العظمة»: a quotation; check the English original wording (*to give them a chance at greatness*).
- «نظام بشار الأسد»: *regime* or *government*? Follow the brief.
- «منذ ربع قرن»: *in 25 years*; English dateline *RIYADH, May 13 –*.

Before you translate

Readers and function:

Which element belongs in the English lead?

Your translation

English headline (maximum 10 words):

TEXT B

English → Arabic · Media and Politics · Wire report (NATO summit)

> NATO leaders meeting in The Hague agreed on Wednesday to raise defence spending to 5 per cent of their countries' gross domestic product by 2035. Under the agreement, at least 3.5 per cent would go to core military spending, with up to 1.5 per cent for related areas such as infrastructure and cybersecurity.
>
> The summit was kept short, and the final declaration ran to just five paragraphs. Spain said it would not need to reach the new target to meet its commitments, while allies reaffirmed their "ironclad commitment" to collective defence under Article 5.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of an international wire service, based on publicly reported events (25 June 2025). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

defence spending = الإنفاق الدفاعي
gross domestic product (GDP) = الناتج المحلي الإجمالي
core military spending = الإنفاق العسكري الأساسي
collective defence = الدفاع الجماعي
final declaration = البيان الختامي

WATCH OUT

- *5 per cent of GDP*: «5 في المائة من الناتج المحلي الإجمالي».
- *ironclad commitment*: «التزام راسخ لا يتزعزع».
- *Article 5*: « المادة الخامسة من معاهدة حلف شمال الأطلسي».

Before you translate

Readers and function:

Which reporting verbs carry attribution?

Your translation

Arabic headline (maximum 10 words):

Extra practice: two shorter texts

Apply the workflow independently: analyse the brief and text type, research terms, then translate.

PRACTICE 1 — **Arabic → English** · Media and Politics · News brief (Gaza ceasefire)

دخل اتفاق وقف إطلاق النار في قطاع غزة حيّز التنفيذ ظهر يوم الجمعة العاشر من أكتوبر/تشرين الأول 2025، في إطار المرحلة الأولى من خطة أعلنها الرئيس الأمريكي دونالد ترامب. وينص الاتفاق على انسحاب جزئي للقوات الإسرائيلية، وتبادل الأسرى والمحتجزين، وإدخال المساعدات الإنسانية إلى القطاع.

وبدأ آلاف النازحين العودة سيرًا على الأقدام نحو مدينة غزة وشمال القطاع، فيما رحّبت عواصم عربية وغربية بالاتفاق ودعت إلى تثبيته.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of a satellite-TV news website, based on publicly reported events (October 2025). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

Your translation

PRACTICE 2 — **Arabic → English** · Media and Politics · News brief (climate summit)

افتُتح يوم الاثنين العاشر من نوفمبر/تشرين الثاني 2025 في مدينة بيليم البرازيلية مؤتمر الأمم المتحدة الثلاثون لتغيّر المناخ «كوب 30». وتنعقد القمة للمرة الأولى على أطراف غابات الأمازون، في رسالة رمزية حول حماية الغابات المطيرة.

وتتركز المفاوضات على تمويل تكيّف الدول النامية مع آثار التغيّر المناخي، وعلى الخطط الوطنية لخفض الانبعاثات، وسط تحذيرات علمية من أن العالم ما زال بعيدًا عن أهداف اتفاق باريس.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of a pan-Arab news website, based on publicly reported events (November 2025). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

Your translation

TRANSLATOR'S LOG

Which features of headlinese did you keep, and which did you change, when you moved between English and Arabic? Note one framing choice you had to make.

LECTURE 02

WEEK 2

CHAPTER 1 · MEDIA AND POLITICS HEADLINES

The News Bulletin: Broadcast Scripts and Leads

Anchor cues, correspondents' reports and the spoken inverted pyramid

By the end of this lecture you will be able to:

- Describe the structure of a radio or television news bulletin.
- Translate anchor cues, leads and correspondents' reports for the ear.
- Use standard Arabic and English broadcast formulae.
- Condense and reorder information for a timed bulletin.

Lecture notes

1. Anatomy of a bulletin

- **Headlines menu** (the main stories in one sentence each), then the **stories in order of importance**.
- Each story: **anchor cue or intro** → **correspondent's package** (voice-over, interviews) → **sign-off**.
- Transitions guide the listener: *We begin in…*, *Elsewhere…*, *Turning now to…* / « نبدأ من…»، «وفي شأن آخر…»، «ننتقل إلى…».

2. Writing and translating for the ear

Broadcast language is written to be **heard once**. Sentences are short, the subject comes first, attribution usually **opens** the sentence (*The ministry says…*), and numbers are rounded (*more than a hundred dollars*). The translator therefore splits long Arabic sentences, removes chains of «و» and «كما», and moves attribution forward. In the other direction, Arabic voice-over keeps Modern Standard Arabic but prefers simple, rhythmic clauses (Bielsa & Bassnett 2009).

3. The lead and the inverted pyramid

The lead answers *who*, *what*, *where*, *when* and, if possible, *why*. Background (*The crisis began…*) comes later. When a bulletin item is translated, the translator may **reorder** the source so that the most newsworthy element comes first: this is legitimate transediting, provided no fact is changed.

4. Live and breaking news

Breaking items are marked «عاجل» / *Breaking news* and are often incomplete: keep hedges (*reports say*, « أفادت تقارير») and never fill gaps with guesses. Times may need converting to the audience's time zone.

Toolkit: broadcast formulae

English	Arabic	Note
Good evening, here are the headlines.	مساء الخير، وإليكم أبرز العناوين.	Opening the bulletin
We begin in Rome, where…	نبدأ من روما، حيث…	First story
Our correspondent sent this report from Doha.	ومن الدوحة، يوافينا مراسلنا بهذا التقرير.	Cue to package

English	Arabic	Note
Elsewhere / In other news…	وفي شأن آخر…	Transition
We'll bring you more on this story as it develops.	وسنوافيكم بالمستجدات تباعًا.	Developing story
That's all from us for now.	إلى هنا نصل إلى ختام هذه النشرة.	Sign-off

Warm-up: think and discuss

1 Listen to the first two minutes of a news bulletin in Arabic and in English. How are the stories introduced and linked?

2 Why do broadcast scripts round numbers and put attribution first?

3 What should a translator do with an unconfirmed detail in a breaking-news item?

Headline workshop

Translate each headline into the other language. Respect the headline conventions of the target language (maximum 10 words).

#	Source headline	Your translation
1	عاجل: دخان أبيض من مدخنة كنيسة سيستينا	
2	انتخاب الكاردينال الأمريكي روبرت بريفوست بابا للفاتيكان	
3	البرلمان اللبناني ينتخب قائد الجيش جوزيف عون رئيسًا	
4	منظمة الصحة العالمية تعتمد أول اتفاق دولي بشأن الجوائح	
5	Grand Egyptian Museum opens its doors	
6	Leo XIV becomes first American pope	

MEDIA WATCH

Record the opening headlines menu of one Arabic and one English bulletin on the same evening (for example BBC Arabic and BBC News, or Sky News Arabia and Sky News). Which stories lead, and in what order?

TEXT A

Arabic → English · Media and Politics · TV bulletin script (anchor intro)

مساء الخير، وأهلًا بكم في نشرة الأخبار. نبدأ من الفاتيكان، حيث تصاعد الدخان الأبيض من مدخنة كنيسة سيستينا، معلنًا انتخاب بابا جديد للكنيسة الكاثوليكية. فقد اختار مجمع الكرادلة الكاردينال الأمريكي روبرت فرنسيس بريفوست، الذي اتخذ اسم لاوُن الرابع عشر، ليصبح أول بابا من الولايات المتحدة في التاريخ.

وكان البابا الجديد قد أمضى سنوات طويلة مبشّرًا في البيرو، وكان يرأس دائرة الأساقفة في الفاتيكان قبل انتخابه. وفي أول كلمة له من شرفة كاتدرائية القديس بطرس، دعا إلى السلام وإلى بناء الجسور بالحوار. ومن روما، يوافينا مراسلنا بهذا التقرير.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of an Arabic satellite-TV bulletin, based on publicly reported events (8 May 2025). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

الدخان الأبيض = white smoke
مجمع الكرادلة = the conclave / College of Cardinals
لاوُن الرابع عشر = Leo XIV
مبشّرًا = as a missionary
شرفة كاتدرائية القديس بطرس = the balcony of St Peter's Basilica

WATCH OUT

- Write for the ear: split the long sentences.
- Papal names have fixed English forms: *Leo XIV*.
- «يوافينا مراسلنا بهذا التقرير»: use a natural English cue.

Before you translate

Readers (listeners) and function:

Which sentence would you cut if the item had to last 20 seconds?

Your translation

English bulletin headline (maximum 10 words):

TEXT B

English → Arabic · Media and Politics · Correspondent's report (global health)

Member states of the World Health Organization have adopted the world's first pandemic agreement, five years after COVID-19 exposed deep inequalities in access to vaccines and treatments. The text was approved at the World Health Assembly in Geneva without objections, although several countries abstained.

The agreement commits countries to strengthen prevention and to share pathogens and the benefits of research more fairly. But a key annex on how that sharing will work is still being negotiated, and the agreement will only take effect once enough countries have ratified it.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of an English-language TV correspondent's report, based on publicly reported events (20 May 2025). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

pandemic agreement = اتفاق بشأن الجوائح
World Health Assembly = جمعية الصحة العالمية
pathogens = مسبّبات الأمراض
annex = ملحق
ratified = صادقت عليه

WATCH OUT

- *without objections, although several countries abstained*: keep both facts.
- *World Health Assembly ≠ World Health Organization*.
- Voice-over Arabic: short MSA sentences with a clear rhythm.

Before you translate

Readers (listeners) and function:

Which terms need checking in WHO Arabic documents?

Your translation

Arabic headline (maximum 10 words):

Extra practice: two shorter texts

Apply the workflow independently: analyse the brief and text type, research terms, then translate.

PRACTICE 1 — **Arabic → English** · Media and Politics · Breaking-news item (Lebanon)

عاجل: انتخب البرلمان اللبناني يوم التاسع من يناير/كانون الثاني 2025 قائد الجيش العماد جوزيف عون رئيسًا للجمهورية في جولة التصويت الثانية، منهيًا شغورًا رئاسيًا استمر أكثر من عامين. ومن المنتظر أن يؤدي الرئيس الجديد اليمين الدستورية أمام المجلس في وقت لاحق اليوم.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of a breaking-news ticker, based on publicly reported events (9 January 2025). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

Your translation

PRACTICE 2 — **English → Arabic** · Media and Politics · Bulletin item (culture and politics)

In Egypt, the Grand Egyptian Museum has been officially opened near the pyramids of Giza, more than two decades after the project was first launched. The museum displays the complete collection of Tutankhamun's treasures together for the first time. Egyptian officials hope it will attract millions of visitors and help revive the tourism sector.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of an English-language radio bulletin, based on publicly reported events (1 November 2025). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

Your translation

TRANSLATOR'S LOG

Where did you reorder, split or shorten the source to make it work for listeners? Was any change more than a translation decision?

LECTURE

03

WEEK 3

CHAPTER 1 · MEDIA AND POLITICS HEADLINES

Diplomacy and Negotiations

Talks, mediation, trade deals and the language of agreement

By the end of this lecture you will be able to:

- Use the English and Arabic terminology of negotiation and agreement precisely.
- Distinguish degrees of commitment (talks, framework, memorandum, treaty).
- Render modality and hedging in diplomatic reporting.
- Translate reports of mediation and failed talks neutrally.

Lecture notes

1. A graded vocabulary

Diplomatic reporting distinguishes carefully between stages: *contacts*, *exploratory talks*, *indirect talks*, *a round of negotiations*, *a framework*, *a memorandum of understanding*, *an interim deal*, *an agreement* and *a treaty*. Each has a fixed Arabic equivalent («جولة»، «محادثات غير مباشرة»، «محادثات استكشافية»، «اتصالات»، «مفاوضات»، «إطار»، «مذكرة تفاهم»، «اتفاق مؤقت»، «اتفاق»، «معاهدة»). Choosing a stronger term than the source is a **mistranslation**, not a stylistic choice.

2. Mediation and hosting

- *mediated by* / «بوساطة»; *hosted by* / «تستضيفها»; *to broker a deal* / «التوسط في اتفاق».
- *shuttle diplomacy* / «دبلوماسية مكوكية»; *on the sidelines of* / «على هامش».
- *The talks ended without agreement* / «انتهت المحادثات من دون التوصل إلى اتفاق»: keep the neutral wording; do not write «فشلت» unless the source does.

3. Modality and hedging

Diplomatic news is full of modal meaning: *is expected to*, *is due to*, *could*, *would* («من»، «من المتوقع أن»، «المقرر أن»، «قد»). Arabic «من المقرر» signals a scheduled event and «من المتوقع» a forecast; English must preserve the difference (Hatim & Mason 1997).

4. Names and titles

Use the established forms of names and offices: *Volodymyr Zelensky* / «فولوديمير زيلينسكي»، *Ahmed al-Sharaa* / «أحمد الشرع»، *President of the European Commission* / «رئيسة المفوضية الأوروبية»، *Secretary of State* / «وزير الخارجية» (US). Check spellings in reliable sources and keep them consistent in your termbase.

Toolkit: the language of negotiation

English	Arabic	Note
memorandum of understanding (MoU)	مذكرة تفاهم	Not yet a treaty
framework agreement	اتفاق إطاري	Sets principles

English	Arabic	Note
interim deal	اتفاق مؤقت	Temporary
round of talks	جولة محادثات	Count rounds
talks stalled	تعثّرت المحادثات	Neutral
confidence-building measures	إجراءات بناء الثقة	Fixed term

Warm-up: think and discuss

1 What is the difference between a memorandum of understanding and a treaty? Why does it matter for a translator?

2 Why might a translator avoid «فشل» when the source says *ended without agreement*?

3 Which countries have acted as mediators in recent crises (for example Turkey, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, Switzerland), and how are they described in the news?

Headline workshop

Translate each headline into the other language. Respect the headline conventions of the target language (maximum 10 words).

#	Source headline	Your translation
1	أول محادثات مباشرة بين روسيا وأوكرانيا منذ 2022	
2	الاتفاق على تبادل ألف أسير مقابل ألف	
3	الشرع أول رئيس سوري يزور البيت الأبيض	
4	جنيف تحتضن محادثات أمريكية أوكرانية بشأن خطة السلام	
5	EU and US strike trade deal with 15% tariff	
6	Syria joins coalition against Islamic State group	

MEDIA WATCH

Find one official statement about negotiations on the website of a foreign ministry or of the European Commission. Compare its wording with the way one news channel reports it.

TEXT A — **Arabic → English** · Media and Politics · News report (Istanbul talks)

إسطنبول – عقد وفدان روسي وأوكراني يوم السادس عشر من مايو/أيار 2025 في إسطنبول أول محادثات مباشرة بينهما منذ ربيع 2022، بحضور مسؤولين أتراك. واستمر الاجتماع أقل من ساعتين، وانتهى من دون التوصل إلى وقف لإطلاق النار.

غير أن الطرفين اتفقا على تبادل ألف أسير حرب من كل جانب، في أكبر عملية تبادل منذ بداية الحرب. ونقلت وسائل إعلام عن مصدر أوكراني أن موسكو طرحت شروطًا «غير مقبولة»، فيما قال رئيس الوفد الروسي إن بلاده «راضية» عن نتائج اللقاء ومستعدة لمواصلة الاتصالات.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of a pan-Arab daily newspaper, based on publicly reported events (May 2025). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

محادثات مباشرة = direct talks
وقف لإطلاق النار = ceasefire
تبادل الأسرى = prisoner exchange
أسير حرب = prisoner of war
مواصلة الاتصالات = continue contacts

WATCH OUT

- «ألف أسير من كل جانب»: *1,000 prisoners each / 1,000-for-1,000 exchange*.
- «نقلت وسائل إعلام عن مصدر»: a second-hand, anonymous attribution; keep it.
- «ربيع 2022»: *spring 2022* (the early months of the war).

Before you translate

Readers and function:

Which words signal the degree of commitment of what was agreed?

Your translation

English headline (maximum 10 words):

TEXT B — **English → Arabic** · Media and Politics · Wire report (trade deal)

The United States and the European Union reached a trade agreement on Sunday that sets a 15 per cent tariff on most EU goods entering the US, averting a trade war that had threatened to disrupt one of the world's largest economic relationships. The deal was announced by President Donald Trump and European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen at Mr Trump's golf resort in Turnberry, Scotland.

Under the framework, the EU also pledged to buy 750 billion dollars' worth of US energy and to invest 600 billion dollars in the United States. Several European leaders welcomed the end of uncertainty, but others said the terms were unbalanced.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of an international wire service, based on publicly reported events (27 July 2025). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

tariff = رسوم جمركية
averting a trade war = تفادي حرب تجارية
European Commission President = رئيسة المفوضية الأوروبية
framework = إطار / اتفاق إطاري
unbalanced = غير متوازنة

WATCH OUT

- *reached a trade agreement … Under the framework*: decide whether «اتفاق» or «اتفاق إطاري» fits.
- Figures: «750 مليار دولار» ،«600 مليار دولار».
- *Several … but others*: unnamed sources; keep the balance.

Before you translate

Readers and function:

Which statements are facts and which are assessments?

Your translation

Arabic headline (maximum 10 words):

Extra practice: two shorter texts

Apply the workflow independently: analyse the brief and text type, research terms, then translate.

PRACTICE 1 **Arabic → English** · Media and Politics · News brief (Syria–US)

استقبل الرئيس الأمريكي دونالد ترامب يوم العاشر من نوفمبر/تشرين الثاني 2025 الرئيس السوري أحمد الشرع في البيت الأبيض، في أول زيارة لرئيس سوري إلى المقر الرئاسي الأمريكي منذ استقلال سوريا عام 1946. وأعلنت واشنطن خلال الزيارة تعليق تطبيق عقوبات «قانون قيصر» لمدة 180 يومًا، فيما انضمت دمشق إلى التحالف الدولي لمكافحة تنظيم الدولة الإسلامية.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of an Arabic news agency dispatch, based on publicly reported events (November 2025). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

Your translation

PRACTICE 2

Arabic → English · Media and Politics · News report (peace plan)

اجتمع وفدان أمريكي وأوكراني في جنيف يوم الثالث والعشرين من نوفمبر/تشرين الثاني 2025 لمناقشة خطة أمريكية من ثمانية وعشرين بندًا لإنهاء الحرب في أوكرانيا. وقال الطرفان في بيان مشترك إنهما توصلا إلى «إطار سلام محدَّث ومنقَّح»، في حين أبدت عواصم أوروبية تحفظات على بعض بنود الخطة الأصلية.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of a satellite-TV news website, based on publicly reported events (November 2025). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

Your translation

TRANSLATOR'S LOG

List the agreement and negotiation terms you used. Did you ever make a commitment sound stronger or weaker than in the source?

LECTURE

04

WEEK 4

CHAPTER 1 · MEDIA AND POLITICS HEADLINES

Reporting Conflict: The Iran–US Crisis

A case study in attribution, casualty figures and the vocabulary of war

By the end of this lecture you will be able to:

- Translate conflict reports with accurate attribution of every claim.
- Render figures, estimates and ranges without distortion.
- Recognise loaded vocabulary and apply a consistent editorial line.
- Handle agentless and passive constructions responsibly.

Lecture notes

1. Every claim has an owner

In conflict reporting, facts are scarce and claims are many. Each statement must keep its **source**: *the army said*, *state media reported*, *according to a monitoring group* («أفاد الجيش»، «ذكرت وسائل الإعلام الرسمية»، «بحسب منظمة لرصد حقوق الإنسان»). A translator who drops an attribution turns a claim into a fact (Baker 2006).

2. Numbers, estimates and ranges

- Keep approximations: *at least* / «ما لا يقل عن»، *nearly* / «قرابة»، *up to* / «ما يصل إلى».
- When sources disagree, the report gives **all figures with their sources**; never average or choose one.
- Check digits, units and dates twice: a wrong number in a war report is a serious error.

3. Loaded vocabulary

Words such as «استشهد» / *was killed*, «عدوان» / *attack*, «ميليشيا» / *militia* or «مقاومة» / *resistance* carry an editorial position. International agencies usually prefer the most neutral form (*killed*, *strike*, *armed group*). The translator applies the client's **editorial line** consistently and notes the issue in the log; inventing a new stance is not acceptable (van Dijk 1988; Baker 2006).

4. Agency and the passive

Passive and agentless forms (*explosions were reported*, «سُمعت انفجارات») may reflect real uncertainty, or may hide responsibility. Translate the degree of agency that the source expresses: do not add an agent that the source does not name, and do not hide one that it does.

Toolkit: the vocabulary of conflict reporting

English	Arabic	Note
airstrike / strike	غارة جوية / ضربة	Neutral
to retaliate	يردّ / ينفّذ ردًّا انتقاميًا	Check register
at least 20 people were killed	قُتل ما لا يقل عن 20 شخصًا	Keep the approximation

English	Arabic	Note
state media reported	ذكرت وسائل الإعلام الرسمية	Attribution
could not be independently verified	لم يتسنَّ التحقق منها من مصدر مستقل	Standard caveat
ceasefire took effect	دخل وقف إطلاق النار حيّز التنفيذ	Fixed collocation

Warm-up: think and discuss

1 Why do international agencies often add *could not be independently verified* to conflict reports?

2 Which Arabic verbs for ‘to be killed’ do you know, and what does each imply?

3 What should a translator do when two sources give very different casualty figures?

Headline workshop

Translate each headline into the other language. Respect the headline conventions of the target language (maximum 10 words).

#	Source headline	Your translation
1	ضربات أمريكية على ثلاث منشآت نووية إيرانية	
2	إيران تستهدف قاعدة العديد الجوية في قطر	
3	الإعلان عن وقف لإطلاق النار بين إيران وإسرائيل	
4	تباين كبير في أعداد ضحايا الاحتجاجات في إيران	
5	US and Israel strike Iran; explosions reported in Tehran	
6	Revolutionary Guards announce ‘offensive’ defence doctrine	

MEDIA WATCH

Compare how two channels (for example Al Arabiya and BBC Arabic) report the same military incident on the same day. List the verbs used for the attack and for the casualties.

TEXT A — **Arabic → English** · Media and Politics · News report (June 2025 strikes)

شنّت الولايات المتحدة فجر يوم الأحد الثاني والعشرين من يونيو/حزيران 2025 ضربات على ثلاث منشآت نووية إيرانية في فوردو ونطنز وأصفهان، في أول تدخل عسكري أمريكي مباشر في الحرب التي اندلعت بين إسرائيل وإيران قبل نحو عشرة أيام. وقال الرئيس الأمريكي إن الضربات حققت أهدافها، فيما أكدت طهران أن المنشآت المستهدفة كانت قد أُخليت مسبقًا.

وفي اليوم التالي، أطلقت إيران صواريخ على قاعدة العديد الجوية في قطر، التي تستضيف قوات أمريكية. وأعلنت الدوحة أن دفاعاتها الجوية اعترضت معظم الصواريخ ولم تُسجَّل إصابات. وبعد ساعات، أعلن ترامب التوصل إلى وقف لإطلاق النار بين إيران وإسرائيل دخل حيّز التنفيذ في الرابع والعشرين من الشهر نفسه.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of an Arabic satellite-TV news website, based on publicly reported events (June 2025). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

- شنّ ضربات = to carry out / launch strikes
- منشآت نووية = nuclear facilities
- أُخليت مسبقًا = had been evacuated beforehand
- اعترضت = intercepted
- لم تُسجَّل إصابات = no casualties were reported

WATCH OUT

- Keep both claims: the US claim of success and Iran's claim of evacuation.
- Place names: *Fordow*, *Natanz*, *Isfahan*; *Al Udeid Air Base*.
- «الحرب التي اندلعت»: the twelve-day war of June 2025.

Before you translate

Readers and function:

Which statements are attributed, and to whom?

Your translation

English headline (maximum 10 words):

TEXT B

English → Arabic · Media and Politics · Agency report (February 2026 strikes)

The United States and Israel carried out military strikes on Iran on Saturday, with explosions reported in the capital, Tehran. Iranian state media initially denied reports that the country's Supreme Leader, Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, had been killed, but later confirmed his death and announced forty days of national mourning.

Iran responded by launching missiles and drones at Israel and at several Gulf countries that host US forces. The full extent of the damage and the number of casualties on all sides could not be independently verified.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of an international news agency, based on publicly reported events (28 February – 1 March 2026). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

military strikes = ضربات عسكرية
Supreme Leader = المرشد الأعلى
national mourning = حداد وطني
drones = طائرات مسيّرة
could not be independently verified = لم يتسنَّ التحقق منه من مصدر مستقل

WATCH OUT

- *explosions reported*: keep the agentless form « أفيد بوقوع انفجارات».
- *initially denied … later confirmed*: keep the sequence.
- Choose and justify your verb for *killed* according to a neutral brief.

Before you translate

Readers and function:

Which verb will you use for *killed*, and why?

Your translation

Arabic headline (maximum 10 words):

Extra practice: two shorter texts

Apply the workflow independently: analyse the brief and text type, research terms, then translate.

PRACTICE 1 — **Arabic → English** · Media and Politics · News report (conflicting figures)

تتباين التقديرات تباينًا كبيرًا بشأن أعداد القتلى في الاحتجاجات التي شهدتها إيران منذ أواخر ديسمبر/كانون الأول 2025، على خلفية انهيار العملة وارتفاع الأسعار. فبينما أعلنت الحكومة الإيرانية مقتل 3117 شخصًا، قدّرت منظمة «هرانا» الحقوقية العدد بنحو سبعة آلاف، مشيرة إلى اعتقال أكثر من 26 ألف شخص. ولم يتسنَّ التحقق من هذه الأرقام من مصدر مستقل.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of an Arabic news website, based on publicly reported events (January–February 2026). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

Your translation

PRACTICE 2 — **Arabic → English** · Media and Politics · News report (new military doctrine)

أعلن الحرس الثوري الإيراني يوم الأربعاء تبنّي عقيدة دفاعية «هجومية وغير متماثلة»، تقوم على عدم الاكتفاء بالرد على الهجمات، بل المبادرة إلى عمليات عسكرية قد تشمل القواعد المستخدمة في العمليات الأمريكية. وفي اليوم نفسه، أمرت وزارة الخارجية الأمريكية موظفيها غير الأساسيين وعائلاتهم بمغادرة السعودية، مشيرة إلى هجمات الحوثيين.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of a pan-Arab news website, based on publicly reported events (21–22 October 2026). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

Your translation

TRANSLATOR'S LOG

Copy one sentence where you had to decide between neutral and loaded vocabulary. Which option did you choose, and what brief justified it?

LECTURE

05

WEEK 5

CHAPTER 1 · MEDIA AND POLITICS HEADLINES

Trade, Energy and the Economy in the News

Tariffs, markets, prices and the economic fallout of politics

By the end of this lecture you will be able to:

- Translate economic and financial terminology used in political news.
- Render prices, percentages and trends accurately in both directions.
- Explain technical terms (tariffs, safe havens, adaptation finance) for a general audience.
- Choose between explicitation and concision according to the brief.

Lecture notes

1. When politics becomes economics

Political decisions are reported as much in the business pages as on the front page. A new tariff, a sanction or a disrupted shipping route immediately produces stories about **prices**, **markets**, **supply chains** and **public finances**. These texts combine journalistic style with specialised terminology, so the translator must manage two registers at once (Olohan 2016).

2. Prices, trends and comparisons

- *Gold rose above $4,000 an ounce* / «ارتفع الذهب إلى أكثر من 4000 دولار للأوقية».
- *jumped*, *surged*, *edged up*, *eased*, *slumped* / « قفز»، «ارتفع بشدة»، «ارتفع قليلًا»، «تراجع»، «هبط بقوة»: keep the intensity.
- *for the first time ever* / «للمرة الأولى في تاريخه»; *the lowest since* / «أدنى مستوى منذ».

3. Trade and finance terms

Economic reports use fixed terms: *tariff* («رسوم جمركية»), *baseline tariff* («رسوم جمركية أساسية»), *reciprocal tariffs* («رسوم جمركية متبادلة»), *safe-haven asset* («ملاذ آمن»), *revenue* («إيرادات»), *adaptation finance* («تمويل التكيّف»). Record each term in your termbase with a reliable source.

4. Explicitation for general readers

A specialised term may need a short explanation for a general audience: *adaptation finance*, *money to help countries cope with the effects of climate change*. Add explanations **only if the brief requires it** (Nord 1997), and keep them short.

Toolkit: trade, markets and finance

English	Arabic	Note
baseline tariff	رسوم جمركية أساسية	Trade
reciprocal tariffs	رسوم جمركية متبادلة	Trade
safe-haven asset	ملاذ آمن	Markets

English	Arabic	Note
record high	مستوى قياسي	Trend
revenue fell by 60 per cent	تراجعت الإيرادات بنسبة 60 في المائة	Figures
supply chain disruption	اضطراب سلاسل الإمداد	Economy

Warm-up: think and discuss

1 How can a tariff decided in Washington affect prices and jobs in North Africa?

2 What is the difference between *surged* and *edged up*? How would you show it in Arabic?

3 When should a translator explain a technical term rather than simply translate it?

Headline workshop

Translate each headline into the other language. Respect the headline conventions of the target language (maximum 10 words).

#	Source headline	Your translation
1	الذهب يتجاوز 4000 دولار للأوقية للمرة الأولى	
2	تراجع حاد في إيرادات قناة السويس بسبب هجمات البحر الأحمر	
3	رسوم جمركية أمريكية شاملة تهز الأسواق العالمية	
4	كوب 30 يتفق على مضاعفة تمويل التكيّف ثلاث مرات	
5	Stocks tumble after sweeping US tariffs	
6	COP30 deal omits fossil fuel roadmap	

MEDIA WATCH

Find one report about markets or trade in an Arabic business outlet (for example Asharq Business or Al Arabiya Business) and one in English (for example Reuters or the BBC). List the verbs used to describe price movements.

TEXT A — **Arabic → English** · Media and Politics · Business news (tariffs)

أعلن الرئيس الأمريكي دونالد ترامب يوم الثاني من أبريل/نيسان 2025، فيما سمّاه «يوم التحرير»، فرض رسوم جمركية أساسية بنسبة 10 في المائة على معظم الواردات إلى الولايات المتحدة، إلى جانب رسوم أعلى على عشرات الدول التي تقول واشنطن إنها تحقق فائضًا تجاريًا كبيرًا معها.

وتراجعت أسواق الأسهم العالمية بقوة في الأيام التالية، وسط مخاوف من حرب تجارية واسعة. وبعد أسبوع، أعلن ترامب تعليق الرسوم الأعلى لمدة تسعين يومًا لإتاحة المجال للمفاوضات، مع الإبقاء على الرسوم الأساسية.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of an Arabic business news website, based on publicly reported events (April 2025). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

رسوم جمركية أساسية = baseline tariff
فائض تجاري = trade surplus
أسواق الأسهم = stock markets
حرب تجارية = trade war
تعليق = pause / suspension

WATCH OUT

- «يوم التحرير»: *"Liberation Day"*, in quotation marks.
- «تراجعت بقوة»: keep the intensity (*fell sharply / tumbled*).
- «التي تقول واشنطن إنها»: keep the attribution of the claim.

Before you translate

Readers and function:

Which figures and dates must appear in the English lead?

Your translation

English headline (maximum 10 words):

TEXT B English → Arabic · Media and Politics · Business news (gold)

Gold rose above 4,000 dollars an ounce for the first time on Wednesday, extending a rally that has seen the metal gain more than 50 per cent this year. Investors have turned to gold as a safe haven amid trade tensions, a shutdown of the US federal government and expectations of further interest-rate cuts.

Central banks have also been buying gold at a steady pace, analysts say. Some warn that the rise has been unusually fast and that prices could fall back sharply if the economic outlook improves.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of an English-language business news website, based on publicly reported events (8 October 2025). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

an ounce = للأوقية
rally = موجة صعود
safe haven = ملاذ آمن
government shutdown = إغلاق حكومي
interest-rate cuts = خفض أسعار الفائدة

WATCH OUT

- *4,000 dollars an ounce*: «4000 دولار للأوقية».
- *extending a rally*: «مواصلًا موجة صعود».
- *analysts say … Some warn*: hedged attribution.

Before you translate

Readers and function:

Which technical terms need checking in a reliable source?

Your translation

Arabic headline (maximum 10 words):

Extra practice: two shorter texts

Apply the workflow independently: analyse the brief and text type, research terms, then translate.

PRACTICE 1 **Arabic → English** · Media and Politics · News brief (Suez Canal)

تراجعت إيرادات قناة السويس بأكثر من 60 في المائة في عام 2024 مقارنة بالعام السابق، بعد أن دفعت هجمات الحوثيين على السفن في البحر الأحمر شركات شحن كبرى إلى

تحويل مسار سفنها حول رأس الرجاء الصالح. ويُعدّ ذلك ضربة لأحد أهم مصادر العملة الصعبة في مصر.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of an Arabic business news website, based on publicly reported events (2025). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

Your translation

PRACTICE 2

Arabic → English · Media and Politics · News report (climate finance)

اختُتم مؤتمر الأمم المتحدة للمناخ «كوب 30» في مدينة بيليم البرازيلية باتفاق يدعو إلى مضاعفة تمويل التكيّف مع آثار التغيّر المناخي ثلاث مرات بحلول عام 2035. غير أن النص النهائي خلا من أي إشارة إلى الوقود الأحفوري، رغم مطالبة أكثر من ثمانين دولة بوضع خريطة طريق للتخلي عنه، وهو ما وعدت الرئاسة البرازيلية بالعمل عليه خارج إطار الأمم المتحدة.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of a satellite-TV news website, based on publicly reported events (November 2025). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

Your translation

TRANSLATOR'S LOG

Which economic or financial terms did you add to your termbase? Note the source you used for each.

LECTURE 06

WEEK 6

CHAPTER 1 · MEDIA AND POLITICS HEADLINES

International Organisations and the Language of Resolutions

UN, EU and agency texts: formulae, modality and official Arabic

By the end of this lecture you will be able to:

- Recognise the structure of a resolution (preambular and operative clauses).
- Use the official Arabic formulae of United Nations texts.
- Translate news reports about votes, abstentions and designations.
- Distinguish binding from non-binding language.

Lecture notes

1. Institutional texts behind the news

Many political news stories report on texts produced by international organisations: Security Council resolutions, statements by the Secretary-General, decisions of the European Union. These texts are themselves translated: the United Nations publishes them in six official languages, **including Arabic**, and the official versions are the first place to look for terminology (Schäffner 2004).

2. The structure of a resolution

- **Preambular paragraphs** begin with participles in italics: *Recalling*, *Expressing deep concern* / « إذ يشير»، «وإذ يعرب عن بالغ القلق».
- **Operative paragraphs** are numbered and begin with verbs: *Calls upon*, *Urges*, *Decides* / « يهيب»، «يحث»، «يقرر».
- *Decides* is binding; *calls upon* and *urges* are not. The translator must keep this gradation.

3. Votes and procedures

News reports describe votes with fixed formulae: *adopted by 13 votes to none, with two abstentions* / «اعتُمد القرار بأغلبية 13 صوتًا مقابل لا شيء، مع امتناع عضوين عن التصويت». *Veto* is «حق النقض (الفيتو)». *Designate as a terrorist organisation* / «يُدرج على قائمة المنظمات الإرهابية».

4. Consistency with official versions

When an official Arabic version exists, quote it rather than retranslating it. When it does not, translate in the same register and **say so** if the brief requires (for example: *unofficial translation* / «ترجمة غير رسمية»).

Toolkit: United Nations formulae

English	Arabic	Note
Recalling its previous resolutions	إذ يشير إلى قراراته السابقة	Preambular
Expressing grave concern	وإذ يعرب عن بالغ القلق	Preambular
Calls upon all parties to	يهيب بجميع الأطراف أن	Operative, non-binding

English	Arabic	Note
Decides to remain seized of the matter	يقرر أن يُبقي المسألة قيد نظره	Closing formula
abstained	امتنع عن التصويت	Vote
unofficial translation	ترجمة غير رسمية	Note for readers

Warm-up: think and discuss

1 Why does the UN publish its documents in Arabic? Where can you find official Arabic versions?

2 What is the difference between *urges* and *decides* in a resolution?

3 Why should a translator quote an official version instead of retranslating it?

Headline workshop

Translate each headline into the other language. Respect the headline conventions of the target language (maximum 10 words).

#	Source headline	Your translation
1	مجلس الأمن يعتمد قرارًا يؤيد خطة السلام في غزة	
2	امتناع روسيا والصين عن التصويت على مشروع القرار	
3	مجلس الأمن يمدد ولاية بعثة «مينورسو» عامًا واحدًا	
4	محكمة العدل الدولية: على الدول التزامات قانونية لحماية المناخ	
5	World Health Assembly adopts pandemic agreement	
6	Draft resolution calls for freedom of navigation	

MEDIA WATCH

Open the UN Digital Library or the UN Arabic website and find the Arabic version of one recent Security Council resolution. Copy two operative paragraphs with their English equivalents into your termbase.

TEXT A — **Arabic → English** · Media and Politics · News report (Security Council vote)

اعتمد مجلس الأمن الدولي يوم الاثنين السابع عشر من نوفمبر/تشرين الثاني 2025 القرار رقم 2803، الذي يؤيد خطة الرئيس الأمريكي لإنهاء الحرب في غزة، ويأذن بإنشاء قوة دولية مؤقتة لتحقيق الاستقرار في القطاع. وحظي القرار بتأييد ثلاثة عشر عضوًا، فيما امتنعت روسيا والصين عن التصويت، ولم يصوّت أي عضو ضده.

ورحّبت عدة دول عربية بالقرار باعتباره خطوة نحو تثبيت وقف إطلاق النار، في حين أبدت أطراف أخرى تحفظات على آليات التنفيذ ودور القوة الدولية والجدول الزمني للانسحاب.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of a UN-news-style Arabic report, based on publicly reported events (17 November 2025). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

اعتمد القرار = adopted the resolution
يأذن بإنشاء = authorises the establishment of
قوة دولية لتحقيق الاستقرار = international stabilisation force
امتنعت عن التصويت = abstained
آليات التنفيذ = implementation mechanisms

WATCH OUT

- Vote formula: *by 13 votes to none, with two abstentions (Russia and China)*.
- «القرار رقم 2803»: *Resolution 2803 (2025)*.
- «أبدت أطراف أخرى تحفظات»: *others expressed reservations* (unnamed).

Before you translate

Readers and function:

Which elements of the vote must appear in the English lead?

Your translation

English headline (maximum 10 words):

TEXT B — English → Arabic · Media and Politics · Draft resolution (fictional)

The Security Council,

Recalling the right of navigation of all vessels in international straits, and expressing grave concern at attacks on commercial shipping and at the plight of seafarers stranded in the region,

1. Calls upon all parties to refrain from any action that endangers commercial shipping or the lives of seafarers;

2. Urges Member States to facilitate the safe return of stranded crews to their countries of origin;

3. Requests the Secretary-General to report to the Council within thirty days;

4. Decides to remain seized of the matter.

Source: Fictional text written for this course in the style of a United Nations draft resolution; it is not an adopted UN text. Names and wording are invented.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

Recalling = إذ يشير إلى

expressing grave concern = وإذ يعرب عن بالغ القلق

Calls upon = يهيب بـ

Urges = يحث

Requests the Secretary-General = يطلب إلى الأمين العام

WATCH OUT

- Keep the paragraph structure and numbering.
- Arabic resolution verbs are in the present tense with the Council as subject.
- *plight* / «محنة»; *remain seized* / « يُبقي المسألة قيد نظره».

Before you translate

Readers and function:

Which verbs are binding and which are not?

Your translation

Arabic title for the draft (maximum 10 words):

Extra practice: two shorter texts

Apply the workflow independently: analyse the brief and text type, research terms, then translate.

PRACTICE 1 — Arabic → English · Media and Politics · News brief (Western Sahara)

اعتمد مجلس الأمن الدولي يوم الحادي والثلاثين من أكتوبر/تشرين الأول 2025 القرار رقم 2797، الذي مدّد ولاية بعثة الأمم المتحدة للاستفتاء في الصحراء الغربية «مينورسو» لمدة عام، ودعا إلى مفاوضات على أساس مقترح الحكم الذاتي الذي قدّمه المغرب عام 2007. وأيّد القرار أحد عشر عضوًا، وامتنعت روسيا والصين وباكستان عن التصويت، فيما لم تشارك الجزائر في التصويت.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of a UN-news-style Arabic report, based on publicly reported events (October 2025). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

Your translation

PRACTICE 2 — Arabic → English · Media and Politics · News brief (international law)

أصدرت محكمة العدل الدولية يوم الثالث والعشرين من يوليو/تموز 2025 رأيًا استشاريًا بالإجماع، أكدت فيه أن على الدول التزامات قانونية بحماية المناخ، وأن الإخلال بهذه الالتزامات قد يُعدّ فعلًا غير مشروع دوليًا. وجاء الرأي بطلب من الجمعية العامة للأمم المتحدة، بعد حملة قادتها دول جزرية صغيرة في المحيط الهادئ.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of a pan-Arab news website, based on publicly reported events (July 2025). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

Your translation

TRANSLATOR'S LOG

Which official Arabic UN formulae did you find, and where? Did you keep the difference between binding and non-binding verbs?

LECTURE

07

WEEK 7

CHAPTER 1 · MEDIA AND POLITICS HEADLINES

Quotations, Reporting Verbs and Stance

Direct and indirect speech in political statements

By the end of this lecture you will be able to:

- Choose reporting verbs that match the stance of the source exactly.
- Convert between direct and indirect speech with correct tense and pronoun shifts.
- Handle quotations that have already been translated from a third language.
- Translate reaction round-ups neutrally.

Lecture notes

1. A scale of reporting verbs

Reporting verbs are not interchangeable. *said* / «قال» is neutral; *stressed* / «أكّد، شدّد» adds emphasis; *warned* / «حذّر» adds threat; *claimed* / «زعم، ادّعى» casts doubt; *acknowledged* / «أقرّ» implies reluctance; *denied* / «نفى» reports a rejection. Replacing a neutral verb with a loaded one changes the message (Hatim & Mason 1997; Bielsa & Bassnett 2009).

2. Direct and indirect speech

- English backshifts tenses in indirect speech: *"We will respond"* → *he said they would respond*.
- Arabic usually keeps the original tense after «قال إن بلاده سترد»: «إن / أن».
- Pronouns and time expressions shift: *today* → *that day* / «اليوم» → «في ذلك اليوم» when needed.

3. Quotations translated twice

Statements by Russian, Chinese or Turkish officials often reach Arabic and English newsrooms **through another language**. A quotation in an Arabic report may itself be a translation of a Russian statement, and the English version may differ. Whenever possible, check the **original statement** or an official translation; if you cannot, keep the quotation marks but do not polish the wording (Schäffner & Bassnett 2010).

4. Reaction round-ups

Reports that list reactions («ردود الفعل الدولية») put many voices side by side. Keep each voice with its own verb, keep the order of the source unless the brief requires otherwise, and do not make some reactions sound stronger than others.

Toolkit: reporting verbs and stance

English	Arabic	Note
said / stated	قال / صرّح	Neutral
stressed / emphasised	أكّد / شدّد على	Emphasis
warned	حذّر من	Threat or risk

English	Arabic	Note
claimed / alleged	زعم / ادّعى	Doubt
acknowledged / admitted	أقرّ / اعترف	Reluctance
denied / rejected	نفى / رفض	Rejection

Warm-up: think and discuss

1 Why can *claimed* be dangerous in a translation of a neutral report?

2 What happens to tenses when you turn a direct quotation into indirect speech in English and in Arabic?

3 Where would you look to check the original wording of a statement by a head of government or a pope?

Headline workshop

Translate each headline into the other language. Respect the headline conventions of the target language (maximum 10 words).

#	Source headline	Your translation
1	توسك: بولندا أقرب ما تكون إلى نزاع مفتوح منذ الحرب العالمية الثانية	
2	بولندا تطلب مشاورات بموجب المادة الرابعة من معاهدة الناتو	
3	الرئاسة الجزائرية: العفو عن صنصال جاء لدواعٍ إنسانية	
4	رامافوزا: جنوب أفريقيا «لن تخضع للتنمّر»	
5	Pope Leo calls for a ‘disarmed and disarming’ peace	
6	Argentina distances itself from G20 declaration	

MEDIA WATCH

Find one statement by a head of government reported by an Arabic channel and by an English channel. Did both use the same reporting verb? Was the quotation direct or indirect?

TEXT A — **Arabic → English** · Media and Politics · Reaction round-up (drones over Poland)

أعلنت بولندا فجر العاشر من سبتمبر/أيلول 2025 أنها أسقطت طائرات مسيّرة روسية اخترقت مجالها الجوي خلال هجوم روسي على أوكرانيا، بمشاركة طائرات من دول حليفة في حلف شمال الأطلسي. وقال رئيس الوزراء دونالد توسك أمام البرلمان إن المجال الجوي البولندي تعرّض لتسعة عشر اختراقًا، محذّرًا من أن بلاده باتت «أقرب ما تكون إلى نزاع مفتوح منذ الحرب العالمية الثانية».

وطلبت وارسو إجراء مشاورات بموجب المادة الرابعة من معاهدة الحلف، فيما أعربت عواصم أوروبية عن تضامنها مع بولندا. في المقابل، نفت موسكو أن تكون قد استهدفت الأراضي البولندية.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of an Arabic satellite-TV news website, based on publicly reported events (September 2025). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

- اخترقت مجالها الجوي = violated / entered its airspace
- مشاورات بموجب المادة الرابعة = consultations under Article 4
- أعربت عن تضامنها = expressed solidarity
- نفت = denied
- نزاع مفتوح = open conflict

WATCH OUT

- Tusk's words exist in English: check the published wording.
- One verb per voice: «قال»، «محذّرًا»، «أعربت»، «نفت».
- «بمشاركة طائرات من دول حليفة»: allied aircraft took part; do not name allies the source does not name.

Before you translate

Readers and function:

List each actor with its reporting verb:

Your translation

English headline (maximum 10 words):

TEXT B

English → Arabic · Media and Politics · News report (first papal address)

> Pope Leo XIV greeted the crowd in St Peter's Square with the words "Peace be with you all", in his first address as head of the Catholic Church. Speaking in Italian and Spanish from the balcony of St Peter's Basilica, he called for "a disarmed and disarming peace" and urged people to build bridges through dialogue.
>
> The new pope also paid tribute to his predecessor, Pope Francis, and sent a special greeting to the diocese of Chiclayo in Peru, where he served as bishop. He did not speak in English, his native language.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of an English-language news agency, based on publicly reported events (8 May 2025). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

greeted the crowd = حيّا الحشود
head of the Catholic Church = رأس الكنيسة الكاثوليكية
disarmed and disarming peace = سلام منزوع السلاح ونازع للسلاح
paid tribute to = أشاد بـ / أثنى على
diocese = أبرشية

WATCH OUT

- The quotations are translations from Italian: check an official Vatican Arabic version if one exists.
- *disarmed and disarming*: a word play; find an Arabic rendering that keeps the parallel.
- *his native language*: «لغته الأم».

Before you translate

Readers and function:

Which reporting verbs show stance?

Your translation

Arabic headline (maximum 10 words):

Extra practice: two shorter texts

Apply the workflow independently: analyse the brief and text type, research terms, then translate.

PRACTICE 1 — **Arabic → English** · Media and Politics · News report (presidential pardon)

أعلنت الرئاسة الجزائرية يوم الثاني عشر من نوفمبر/تشرين الثاني 2025 أن الرئيس عبد المجيد تبون أصدر عفوًا عن الكاتب الفرنسي الجزائري بوعلام صنصال، البالغ من العمر 81 عامًا، استجابةً لطلب من الرئيس الألماني فرانك فالتر شتاينماير. ووصفت الرئاسة الطلب بأنه جدير بالاهتمام «لطابعه الإنساني»، فيما أعلنت برلين أنها ستتكفل بنقل الكاتب وعلاجه. وكان صنصال قد صدر بحقه حكم بالسجن خمس سنوات بتهمة المساس بالوحدة الوطنية، وهي تهمة نفاها.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of a pan-Arab news website, based on publicly reported events (November 2025). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

Your translation

PRACTICE 2 — **English → Arabic** · Media and Politics · News report (G20 statements)

G20 leaders meeting in Johannesburg adopted a declaration at the start of the summit, breaking with tradition, despite a boycott by the United States. South Africa's President Cyril Ramaphosa said the declaration showed that multilateralism "can and does deliver", adding that his country "will not be bullied". Argentina, whose president skipped the summit, said it did not endorse the text.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of an English-language news website, based on publicly reported events (22 November 2025). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

Your translation

TRANSLATOR'S LOG

Copy two reporting verbs from the source and your translations of them. Did your verbs keep exactly the same stance?

LECTURE

08

WEEK 8

CHAPTER 1 · MEDIA AND POLITICS HEADLINES

Elections and Domestic Politics

Campaigns, systems and results from Baghdad to The Hague and Warsaw

By the end of this lecture you will be able to:

- Use the terminology of elections, parliaments and coalitions in both languages.
- Translate political labels (centre-right, far right, populist) consistently.
- Render names of parties, institutions and offices according to established usage.
- Distinguish projections, polls and official results.

Lecture notes

1. Institutions and systems

Electoral news assumes knowledge of each country's system. Iraq's parliament is the **Council of Representatives** («مجلس النواب العراقي»), with 329 seats; the Netherlands elects 150 members of the **House of Representatives** («مجلس النواب الهولندي»); Germany's parliament is the **Bundestag** («البوندستاغ»). Do not replace a foreign institution with a local one; add a short explanation only if the brief requires it.

2. Polls, projections and results

- *opinion poll* / «استطلاع رأي»; *exit poll* / «استطلاع آراء الناخبين عند الخروج من مراكز الاقتراع».
- *projections* / «تقديرات»; *preliminary results* / «نتائج أولية»; *official results* / «نتائج رسمية».
- *turnout* / «نسبة المشاركة»; *threshold* / «العتبة الانتخابية»; *coalition* / «ائتلاف»; *landslide* / « فوز ساحق».

3. Political labels

Labels such as *conservative* («محافظ»), *centre-left* («يسار الوسط»), *far right* («اليمين المتطرف») or *populist* («شعبوي») are evaluative. Keep the label the source uses, apply it consistently, and note in the log if the target outlet uses a different convention (Fairclough 1995).

4. Names of parties and people

Use established forms: *Christian Democratic Union (CDU)* / «الاتحاد الديمقراطي المسيحي»، *Party for Freedom (PVV)* / «حزب من أجل الحرية». Keep acronyms when they are familiar to readers (*D66*), and record new names with a reliable source in your termbase.

Toolkit: elections and parliaments

English	Arabic	Note
midterm elections	الانتخابات النصفية	US
general election	انتخابات عامة	Parliamentary systems
to form a coalition	تشكيل ائتلاف حكومي	Coalition politics

English	Arabic	Note
electoral threshold	العتبة الانتخابية	Minimum share
to be sworn in	يؤدي اليمين الدستورية	Inauguration
second round of voting	جولة تصويت ثانية	Procedure

Warm-up: think and discuss

1 Why is it risky to translate *far right* or *populist* without checking the source's usage?

2 What is the difference between a projection and an official result?

3 How would you explain the Dutch party name *D66* to Arab readers in one short phrase?

Headline workshop

Translate each headline into the other language. Respect the headline conventions of the target language (maximum 10 words).

#	Source headline	Your translation
1	ائتلاف السوداني يتصدر الانتخابات العراقية	
2	نسبة المشاركة في الانتخابات العراقية تتجاوز 56 في المائة	
3	ميرتس مستشارًا لألمانيا بعد جولة تصويت ثانية	
4	نافروتسكي رئيسًا لبولندا بفارق ضئيل	
5	Dutch centrists edge out far right in tight vote	
6	Iraq faces long coalition talks after election	

MEDIA WATCH

Compare the coverage of one European election on an Arabic channel and an English channel (for example France 24 Arabic and France 24 English, or DW Arabic and DW English). How are parties and political labels translated?

TEXT A — **Arabic → English** · Media and Politics · Election results (Iraq)

تصدّر ائتلاف «الإعمار والتنمية» بزعامة رئيس الوزراء محمد شياع السوداني نتائج الانتخابات البرلمانية العراقية التي جرت في الحادي عشر من نوفمبر/تشرين الثاني 2025، بحصوله على نحو 1.3 مليون صوت، وفق النتائج الأولية التي أعلنتها المفوضية العليا المستقلة للانتخابات. وبلغت نسبة المشاركة 56 في المائة.

وجاءت الانتخابات في ظل مقاطعة التيار الصدري بدعوة من زعيمه مقتدى الصدر، ما انعكس على نسبة المشاركة في بغداد والنجف. ولا يستطيع أي حزب تشكيل الحكومة منفردًا في مجلس النواب المؤلف من 329 مقعدًا، ما يرجّح مفاوضات طويلة لتشكيل ائتلاف حاكم.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of an Arabic satellite-TV news website, based on publicly reported events (November 2025). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

- «ائتلاف الإعمار والتنمية» = Reconstruction and Development Coalition
- النتائج الأولية = preliminary results
- المفوضية العليا المستقلة للانتخابات = Independent High Electoral Commission
- نسبة المشاركة = turnout
- مقاطعة = boycott

WATCH OUT

- Coalition names vary in English sources: choose one form and keep it.
- «وفق النتائج الأولية»: keep *preliminary*.
- «التيار الصدري»: *the Sadrist Movement*.

Before you translate

Readers and function:

What does an English reader need to know about Iraq's system that an Iraqi reader does not?

Your translation

English headline (maximum 10 words):

TEXT B

English → Arabic · Media and Politics · Election results (Netherlands)

The centrist D66 party, led by Rob Jetten, narrowly won the Dutch general election, finishing ahead of Geert Wilders' far-right Party for Freedom (PVV). Official results confirmed that both parties won 26 of the 150 seats in the House of Representatives, but D66 received about 30,000 more votes, giving Mr Jetten the first chance to try to form a coalition.

Turnout was 78 per cent. The result marked a strong comeback for D66, which had won only nine seats in 2023, while the PVV lost eleven. Coalition talks in the Netherlands often take several months.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of an English-language news agency, based on publicly reported events (October–November 2025). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

centrist = وسطي
narrowly won = فاز بفارق ضئيل
far-right = اليمين المتطرف
to form a coalition = تشكيل ائتلاف حكومي
comeback = عودة قوية

WATCH OUT

- *Party for Freedom (PVV)*: «حزب من أجل الحرية».
- *both parties won 26 seats … but D66 received more votes*: keep the logic.
- *78 per cent*: «78 في المائة».

Before you translate

Readers and function:

Which facts would you check before publication?

Your translation

Arabic headline (maximum 10 words):

Extra practice: two shorter texts

Apply the workflow independently: analyse the brief and text type, research terms, then translate.

PRACTICE 1

Arabic → English · Media and Politics · News report (Germany)

انتخب البرلمان الألماني «البوندستاغ» زعيم الاتحاد الديمقراطي المسيحي فريدريش ميرتس مستشارًا للبلاد في السادس من مايو/أيار 2025، في جولة تصويت ثانية، بعد أن أخفق في الحصول على الأغلبية المطلوبة في الجولة الأولى، وهي سابقة في تاريخ ألمانيا بعد الحرب العالمية الثانية. وكان تحالفه قد حلّ أولًا في الانتخابات التي أُجريت في فبراير/شباط، متقدمًا على حزب «البديل من أجل ألمانيا» اليميني المتطرف.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of an Arabic news agency dispatch, based on publicly reported events (May 2025). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

Your translation

PRACTICE 2

Arabic → English · Media and Politics · News brief (Poland)

فاز المؤرخ المحافظ كارول نافروتسكي، المدعوم من حزب «القانون والعدالة»، بالانتخابات الرئاسية البولندية التي جرت جولتها الثانية في الأول من يونيو/حزيران 2025، بحصوله على 50.89 في المائة من الأصوات، متقدمًا بفارق ضئيل على عمدة وارسو رافاو تشاسكوفسكي، مرشح الائتلاف الحاكم.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of a pan-Arab news website, based on publicly reported events (June 2025). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

Your translation

TRANSLATOR'S LOG

Which institutional names and political labels did you translate? Did you add any explanation for readers, and was it justified by the brief?

LECTURE

09

WEEK 9

CHAPTER 1 · MEDIA AND POLITICS HEADLINES

Humanitarian Crises and Incidents

Displacement, disasters and the ethics of reporting suffering

By the end of this lecture you will be able to:

- Use precise humanitarian terminology (refugees, displaced persons, corridors).
- Translate the names and acronyms of UN and humanitarian agencies.
- Report victims and survivors with accuracy and dignity.
- Translate disaster reports with figures and sources intact.

Lecture notes

1. Precise categories

Humanitarian terms have legal meanings. A **refugee** («لاجئ») has crossed a border; an **internally displaced person (IDP)** («نازح داخلي») has not; an **asylum seeker** («طالب لجوء») has applied for protection. Confusing them is a factual error, not a stylistic one.

2. Agencies and acronyms

- *UNHCR* / «المفوضية السامية للأمم المتحدة لشؤون اللاجئين»; *WFP* / «برنامج الأغذية العالمي»; *OCHA* / «مكتب الأمم المتحدة لتنسيق الشؤون الإنسانية».
- *IMO* / «المنظمة البحرية الدولية»; *ICRC* / «اللجنة الدولية للصليب الأحمر».
- Use the agency's own Arabic name, available on its website.

3. Dignity and accuracy

Reports of suffering must be accurate and respectful. Prefer *people with disabilities* to *the disabled*, *survivors* to *victims* when the source does, and avoid sensational adjectives the source does not use. Keep figures with their sources and dates, because humanitarian numbers change quickly (Baker 2006).

4. Disasters

Disaster reports follow a fixed pattern: event (magnitude, place, time) → toll (killed, injured, missing) → response (rescue, aid) → appeals. Magnitudes and times are technical data: copy them exactly.

Toolkit: humanitarian terminology

English	Arabic	Note
internally displaced persons (IDPs)	النازحون داخليًا	Inside the country
refugees	اللاجئون	Across a border
humanitarian corridor	ممر إنساني	Safe passage
aid convoy	قافلة مساعدات	Logistics
death toll rose to	ارتفعت حصيلة القتلى إلى	Updates

English	Arabic	Note
a magnitude 7.7 earthquake	زلزال بقوة 7.7 درجات	Technical data

Warm-up: think and discuss

1 What is the difference between a refugee and a displaced person? Why does it matter?

2 Where can you find the official Arabic name of a UN agency?

3 Which words should a translator avoid when reporting on victims of a disaster?

Headline workshop

Translate each headline into the other language. Respect the headline conventions of the target language (maximum 10 words).

#	Source headline	Your translation
1	قوات الدعم السريع تسيطر على مدينة الفاشر	
2	عشرات الآلاف يفرّون إلى مخيمات طويلة	
3	فيضانات مدمّرة تجتاح منطقة فالنسيا الإسبانية	
4	أكثر من مليون لاجئ سوري عادوا إلى بلادهم	
5	Famine confirmed in Gaza City, UN-backed experts say	
6	UN warns of ‘unimaginable atrocities’ in El Fasher	

MEDIA WATCH

Visit the Arabic and English pages of one UN agency (for example UN News, UNHCR or WFP). Compare one humanitarian update in both languages and note three terms for your termbase.

TEXT A — **Arabic → English** · Media and Politics · Humanitarian news report (Sudan)

سيطرت قوات الدعم السريع في أواخر أكتوبر/تشرين الأول 2025 على مدينة الفاشر، عاصمة ولاية شمال دارفور، بعد حصار استمر نحو ثمانية عشر شهرًا. وأفادت تقارير أممية وشهادات ناجين بوقوع عمليات قتل جماعي وانتهاكات واسعة بحق المدنيين، فيما حذّر مكتب الأمم المتحدة لحقوق الإنسان من «فظائع لا يمكن تصوّرها».

وفرّ عشرات الآلاف من سكان المدينة سيرًا على الأقدام نحو بلدة طويلة ومناطق أخرى، في ظروف إنسانية بالغة الصعوبة، وسط نقص حاد في الغذاء والمياه والرعاية الطبية. وتقول منظمات الإغاثة إن كثيرًا من الأطفال وصلوا إلى المخيمات من دون ذويهم.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of an Arabic satellite-TV news website, based on publicly reported events (October–November 2025). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

قوات الدعم السريع = Rapid Support Forces (RSF)

حصار = siege

قتل جماعي = mass killings

ناجون = survivors

من دون ذويهم = unaccompanied / without their families

WATCH OUT

- Place names: *El Fasher*, *North Darfur*, *Tawila*.
- «أفادت تقارير ... بوقوع»: keep the attribution.
- «فظائع لا يمكن تصوّرها»: a quotation; check the agency's English wording.

Before you translate

Readers and function:

Which statements are facts, and which are reports or warnings?

Your translation

English headline (maximum 10 words):

TEXT B

English → Arabic · Media and Politics · News report (famine declaration)

> Famine has been confirmed in Gaza City and its surroundings, according to the Integrated Food Security Phase Classification (IPC), the UN-backed system for measuring hunger. It is the first time a famine has been officially confirmed in the Middle East. The experts said that more than half a million people across the Gaza Strip faced catastrophic conditions and warned that famine was expected to spread to Deir al-Balah and Khan Younis.
>
> UN officials said the famine was entirely man-made and could be halted if aid were allowed to enter at scale. Israel rejected the findings.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of an English-language news website, based on publicly reported events (22 August 2025). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

Integrated Food Security Phase Classification (IPC) = التصنيف المرحلي المتكامل للأمن الغذائي
catastrophic conditions = ظروف كارثية
man-made = من صنع الإنسان
at scale = على نطاق واسع / بكميات كافية
rejected the findings = رفضت هذه النتائج

WATCH OUT

- *famine* is a technical classification here: «مجاعة» (IPC Phase 5).
- *according to …*: keep the attribution in the lead.
- *Israel rejected the findings*: keep the reaction, neutral verb.

Before you translate

Readers and function:

Which sentence gives a technical definition, and which gives reactions?

Your translation

Arabic headline (maximum 10 words):

Extra practice: two shorter texts

Apply the workflow independently: analyse the brief and text type, research terms, then translate.

PRACTICE 1

Arabic → English · Media and Politics · Disaster report (Spain)

اجتاحت فيضانات عارمة منطقة فالنسيا في شرق إسبانيا يوم التاسع والعشرين من أكتوبر/تشرين الأول 2024، إثر أمطار غزيرة غير مسبوقة، ما أسفر عن مقتل أكثر من مئتين وعشرين شخصًا. وانتقد كثير من السكان تأخر إرسال رسائل الإنذار إلى هواتفهم، فيما أعلنت الحكومة الإسبانية حزمة مساعدات لإعادة الإعمار.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of an Arabic news agency dispatch, based on publicly reported events (October–November 2024). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

Your translation

PRACTICE 2

Arabic → English · Media and Politics · Humanitarian brief (Syria)

قالت المفوضية السامية للأمم المتحدة لشؤون اللاجئين إن أكثر من مليون لاجئ سوري عادوا إلى بلادهم منذ سقوط النظام السابق في ديسمبر/كانون الأول 2024، إلى جانب عدد أكبر من النازحين داخليًا الذين رجعوا إلى مناطقهم. وحذّرت المفوضية من أن كثيرًا من العائدين يجدون منازلهم مدمّرة ويفتقرون إلى الخدمات الأساسية.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of a UN-news-style Arabic report, based on publicly reported events (2025). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

Your translation

TRANSLATOR'S LOG

Which humanitarian categories (refugee, displaced, survivor) appeared in your texts? Did you translate them precisely and with dignity?

LECTURE

10

WEEK 10

CHAPTER 1 · MEDIA AND POLITICS HEADLINES

Summits and the Global Agenda

Leaders' meetings, declarations and diplomatic protocol

By the end of this lecture you will be able to:

- Translate reports of summits, declarations and joint statements.
- Use correct titles, forms of address and protocol terms.
- Render evaluative adjectives used by leaders (productive, constructive) faithfully.
- Explain the context of a summit briefly when the brief requires it.

Lecture notes

1. The summit report

Summit reports combine **protocol** (who attended, who chaired), **documents** (declarations, joint statements, communiqués) and **assessments** (*productive*, *constructive*, *frank*). Each layer has fixed language: *co-chaired by* / «برئاسة مشتركة»، *joint statement* / «بيان مشترك»، *final communiqué* / «البيان الختامي».

2. Diplomatic adjectives

- *constructive* / «بنّاءة», *productive* / «مثمرة», *frank* / «صريحة» (often a sign of disagreement).
- *cordial* / «ودّية»; *in-depth* / «معمّقة»; *historic* / «تاريخية»: keep the leader's adjective, but attribute it.
- Never upgrade or downgrade an assessment: *useful* is not *very successful*.

3. Titles and forms of address

Use established forms: *President* / «الرئيس»، *Emir of Qatar* / «أمير قطر»، *Crown Prince* / «وليّ العهد»، *Chancellor* / «المستشار». English usually gives a title once and the surname afterwards; Arabic repeats the title more often. Adapt to the target convention.

4. Context for the reader

A summit report often assumes background knowledge (*the Alaska summit*, *the Doha summit*). Add a short clause of context only if the brief and the space allow (Nord 1997).

Toolkit: summits and protocol

English	Arabic	Note
co-chaired by	برئاسة مشتركة لـ	Protocol
joint statement	بيان مشترك	Document
final communiqué	البيان الختامي	Document
on the sidelines of the summit	على هامش القمة	Fixed phrase
talks were described as constructive	وُصفت المحادثات بأنها بنّاءة	Attributed assessment

English	Arabic	Note
emergency summit	قمة طارئة	Type of summit

Warm-up: think and discuss

1 What does *frank talks* usually mean in diplomatic language?

2 Why should a translator attribute adjectives such as *historic* or *productive*?

3 Which summits have you seen reported in Arabic and English media this year?

Headline workshop

Translate each headline into the other language. Respect the headline conventions of the target language (maximum 10 words).

#	Source headline	Your translation
1	قمة شرم الشيخ للسلام بمشاركة أكثر من عشرين دولة	
2	قمة عربية إسلامية طارئة في الدوحة	
3	ترامب وبوتين يلتقيان في ألاسكا	
4	قمة باريس للذكاء الاصطناعي: واشنطن ولندن لا توقّعان الإعلان	
5	No deal on Ukraine after Alaska summit	
6	Leaders sign declaration backing Gaza ceasefire	

MEDIA WATCH

Find the final declaration of one recent summit on an official website (for example the Arab League or the G7 presidency). Compare one paragraph with the way a news channel summarised it.

TEXT A — **Arabic → English** · Media and Politics · Summit report (Sharm el-Sheikh)

استضافت مدينة شرم الشيخ المصرية يوم الاثنين الثالث عشر من أكتوبر/تشرين الأول 2025 «قمة السلام» برئاسة مشتركة للرئيس المصري عبد الفتاح السيسي والرئيس الأمريكي دونالد ترامب، وبمشاركة قادة ومسؤولين من أكثر من عشرين دولة ومنظمة.

ووقّع قادة الولايات المتحدة ومصر وقطر وتركيا وثيقة تدعم اتفاق وقف إطلاق النار في غزة، في اليوم نفسه الذي شهد إطلاق سراح المحتجزين الإسرائيليين الأحياء والإفراج عن قرابة ألفي أسير فلسطيني. وأكد المشاركون ضرورة تثبيت التهدئة والانتقال إلى مرحلة إعادة الإعمار.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of an Arabic satellite-TV news website, based on publicly reported events (13 October 2025). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

برئاسة مشتركة = co-chaired by
وثيقة تدعم = a document backing
المحتجزون = hostages / detainees
الأسرى = prisoners
إعادة الإعمار = reconstruction

WATCH OUT

- «المحتجزين» and «الأسرى»: two different groups; check the convention of your target outlet.
- «قمة السلام»: *peace summit*; capitalise according to style.
- «أكثر من عشرين دولة ومنظمة»: countries and organisations.

Before you translate

Readers and function:

How will you translate «المحتجزين» and «الأسرى»? Justify.

Your translation

English headline (maximum 10 words):

TEXT B — **English → Arabic** · Media and Politics · Summit report (Alaska)

President Donald Trump and President Vladimir Putin met in Alaska on Friday for their first face-to-face summit since Mr Trump returned to the White House. The talks, held at a military base in Anchorage, lasted nearly three hours but ended without an agreement on a ceasefire in Ukraine.

Mr Trump described the meeting as “extremely productive”, while Mr Putin called it constructive. “There’s no deal until there’s a deal,” Mr Trump said, adding that a few points remained unresolved. Ukraine’s President Volodymyr Zelensky, who did not attend, said that any agreement must involve Kyiv.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of an English-language wire report, based on publicly reported events (15 August 2025). Not a broadcaster’s script; details simplified for training.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

face-to-face summit = قمة مباشرة / وجهًا لوجه
military base = قاعدة عسكرية
productive = مثمرة
unresolved = عالقة / لم تُحسم
Kyiv = كييف

WATCH OUT

- *Mr Trump*: Arabic usually repeats «الرئيس ترامب».
- The quotation is a fixed phrase: find a natural Arabic equivalent.
- *who did not attend*: non-restrictive clause.

Before you translate

Readers and function:

How will you render the direct quotation?

Your translation

Arabic headline (maximum 10 words):

Extra practice: two shorter texts

Apply the workflow independently: analyse the brief and text type, research terms, then translate.

PRACTICE 1 **Arabic → English** · Media and Politics · Summit brief (artificial intelligence)

اختُتمت في باريس يوم الحادي عشر من فبراير/شباط 2025 «قمة العمل بشأن الذكاء الاصطناعي» بإعلان يدعو إلى ذكاء اصطناعي «شامل ومستدام»، وقّعته نحو ستين دولة بينها فرنسا والصين والهند. غير أن الولايات المتحدة والمملكة المتحدة امتنعتا عن التوقيع، وحذّر نائب الرئيس الأمريكي من «الإفراط في التنظيم».

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of a pan-Arab news website, based on publicly reported events (February 2025). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

Your translation

PRACTICE 2

Arabic → English · Media and Politics · Summit brief (Doha)

عُقدت في الدوحة يوم الخامس عشر من سبتمبر/أيلول 2025 قمة عربية إسلامية طارئة، بعد أيام من الغارة الإسرائيلية التي استهدفت قياديين في حركة حماس في العاصمة القطرية. وأدان القادة المشاركون الهجوم، وأكدوا تضامنهم الكامل مع قطر ودعمهم لدورها في الوساطة.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of an Arabic news agency dispatch, based on publicly reported events (September 2025). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

Your translation

TRANSLATOR'S LOG

Which diplomatic adjectives and titles appeared in your texts? Did you keep each assessment attributed to the person who made it?

LECTURE

11

WEEK 11

CHAPTER 1 · MEDIA AND POLITICS HEADLINES

Editorials, Opinion and Analysis

Translating argument, evaluation and rhetoric

By the end of this lecture you will be able to:

- Distinguish news, analysis and opinion genres and their conventions.
- Translate evaluative language, metaphor and rhetorical questions faithfully.
- Recreate Arabic editorial rhetoric in natural English, and English argument in natural Arabic.
- Keep the author's stance without adding or softening it.

Lecture notes

1. Three genres

News reports facts with attribution; **analysis** explains causes and consequences with hedged judgements; **opinion** (editorials, columns) argues openly. Each has its own markers: *could*, *is likely to* in analysis; *must*, *it is time*, rhetorical questions in opinion. The translator reproduces the genre, not only the words (Hatim & Mason 1997).

2. Arabic editorial rhetoric

- Parallelism and repetition («إمّا ... وإمّا ...»، «لا ... ولا ...») often become **one** well-built English sentence.
- Emphatic «إنّ» and «لقد» rarely need an English equivalent; emphasis comes from word order and vocabulary.
- Collocations and proverbs need functional equivalents, not literal ones (Dickins, Hervey & Higgins 2017).

3. Metaphor and evaluation

Political metaphors (*a powder keg* / «برميل بارود», *a bottleneck* / «عنق زجاجة», *the race for AI* / «سباق الذكاء الاصطناعي») carry evaluation. Keep the image when it works in the target language; otherwise translate its meaning. Never sharpen or soften the author's stance.

4. Who is speaking?

An editorial speaks for the newspaper; a column for its author; an analysis for an expert. Your translation must make the voice clear (*The paper argues*, «يرى الكاتب»), especially when the text is quoted in another outlet.

Toolkit: argument and evaluation

English	Arabic	Note
It is time for…	آن الأوان لـ…	Call to action
at a crossroads	على مفترق طرق	Metaphor
a powder keg	برميل بارود	Metaphor
is likely to	من المرجح أن	Hedged analysis
What is at stake is…	إن ما هو على المحك…	Framing

English	Arabic	Note
In other words,	بعبارة أخرى،	Reformulation

Warm-up: think and discuss

1 How can you tell an editorial from an analysis in the same newspaper?

2 Which Arabic rhetorical devices sound unnatural when translated literally into English?

3 Is it acceptable for a translator to tone down an opinion they disagree with? Why or why not?

Headline workshop

Translate each headline into the other language. Respect the headline conventions of the target language (maximum 10 words).

#	Source headline	Your translation
1	حين يجفّ السدّ تتكاثر الأسئلة	
2	هل تتعلم المنطقة من دروس الجفاف؟	
3	الحقيقة أولى ضحايا الحروب	
4	النفط الغالي: نعمة لقلة ونقمة لكثيرين	
5	What Europe's AI law means for the rest of the world	
6	The real cost of a long crisis	

MEDIA WATCH

Find one editorial or column on water, climate or technology in an Arabic newspaper and one in an English newspaper. Underline the evaluative words and rhetorical questions in each.

TEXT A — **Arabic → English** · Media and Politics · Editorial (water scarcity)

حين يجفّ السدّ، تتكاثر الأسئلة. فسنوات الجفاف المتتالية في المنطقة المتوسطية لم تعد استثناءً عابرًا، بل صارت قاعدة تفرض نفسها على الفلاح في حقله وعلى الأسرة في مطبخها وعلى الدولة في ميزانيتها.

ولا يكفي أن ننتظر المطر، ولا أن نعلّق كل شيء على مشاريع تحلية لم تكتمل بعد. إن ما هو على المحك اليوم ليس منسوب السدود فحسب، بل قدرتنا على إصلاح شبكات مهترئة، وعلى ترشيد الري، وعلى مصارحة المواطنين بأن الماء لم يعد موردًا لا ينضب.

Source: Original editorial written for this course. The opinions are illustrative and are not those of any outlet.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

الجفاف = drought
استثناءً عابرًا = a passing exception
مشاريع تحلية = desalination projects
منسوب السدود = dam levels
ترشيد الري = rationalising irrigation

WATCH OUT

- Opening image «يجفّ … تتكاثر»: try to keep its punch.
- «على الفلاح … وعلى الأسرة … وعلى الدولة»: tricolon; keep the rhythm.
- «إن ما هو على المحك»: no need to translate «إن».

Before you translate

Readers and function:

Which images or rhetorical devices will you keep?

Your translation

English title (maximum 10 words):

TEXT B — **English → Arabic** · Media and Politics · Explainer / analysis (AI regulation)

What does Europe's new law on artificial intelligence actually do? The EU AI Act, which entered into force in August 2024, classifies AI systems according to their level of risk. Some uses, such as social scoring by governments, are banned outright; others, such as AI used in recruitment or education, must meet strict requirements.

The rules apply in stages, with most obligations originally due to take effect by August 2026, although the European Commission has since proposed delaying some of them. Analysts say the law is likely to influence regulation far beyond Europe, because companies that want access to the EU market will have to comply, but critics argue it could slow innovation.

Source: Original explainer written for this course. The opinions are illustrative and are not those of any outlet.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

entered into force = دخل حيّز التنفيذ
level of risk = مستوى الخطورة
social scoring = التنقيط الاجتماعي
banned outright = محظور كليًا
to comply = الامتثال

WATCH OUT

- The opening rhetorical question: keep it as a question.
- *in stages*: «على مراحل».
- *Analysts say / is likely to / critics argue*: hedged analysis with two sides.

Before you translate

Readers and function:

Which features show that this is analysis, not opinion?

Your translation

Arabic title (maximum 10 words):

Extra practice: two shorter texts

Apply the workflow independently: analyse the brief and text type, research terms, then translate.

PRACTICE 1 — **Arabic → English** · Media and Politics · Opinion column (misinformation)

يُقال إن الحقيقة هي أولى ضحايا الحروب. وفي زمن المنصات الرقمية، لم تعد الشائعة تحتاج إلى أكثر من ثوانٍ لتعبر القارات، ولم يعد المقطع المفبرك يحتاج إلى أكثر من هاتف. لذلك يبقى واجب الصحفي، والمترجم أيضًا، أن يتحقق قبل أن ينشر، وأن يتذكر أن السرعة لا تبرر الخطأ.

Source: Original opinion column written for this course. The opinions are illustrative and are not those of any outlet.

Your translation

PRACTICE 2

Arabic → English · Media and Politics · Analysis (energy importers)

قد تبدو أسعار النفط المرتفعة خبرًا سارًا للدول المصدّرة، لكنها تمثل عبئًا ثقيلًا على الاقتصادات المستوردة للطاقة، ومنها عدد من دول شمال أفريقيا. فكل زيادة في سعر البرميل تنعكس على كلفة النقل والكهرباء والغذاء، وتضغط على موازنات تتحمل أصلًا أعباء دعم المحروقات.

Source: Original analysis written for this course. The opinions are illustrative and are not those of any outlet.

Your translation

TRANSLATOR'S LOG

Did your translation keep the author's stance exactly? Note one place where you were tempted to soften or sharpen it.

LECTURE

12

WEEK 12

CHAPTER 1 · MEDIA AND POLITICS HEADLINES

Newsroom Simulation: Transediting a Full Bulletin

A professional task that brings the chapter together

By the end of this lecture you will be able to:

- Plan and carry out a complete news-translation task under time constraints.
- Select, reorder and condense information for a target bulletin (transediting).
- Apply consistent terminology, attribution and editorial choices across items.
- Revise a colleague's translation and justify decisions in a commentary.

Lecture notes

1. The newsroom workflow

In a real newsroom, translation is one step in a chain: **selection** (which items to use), **translation and transediting**, **revision** by an editor, and **publication or broadcast**. Each step is guided by the outlet's style guide and by time: a radio bulletin may give a translator minutes, not hours (Bielsa & Bassnett 2009; Davier, Schäffner & van Doorslaer 2018).

2. Roles for this simulation

- **Editor:** decides the order and the length of each item and checks the brief.
- **Translators:** translate and condense the items assigned to them.
- **Reviser:** checks meaning, figures, names, attribution and style; produces the final version.
- Rotate roles between Text 1 and Text 2.

3. What is assessed

Accuracy of facts and figures; fidelity of attribution and stance; quality of the target language; respect for the brief (length, audience, medium); and the quality of the **commentary** that explains your decisions.

Toolkit: revision checklist for news translation

English	Arabic	Note
Names and titles	الأسماء والألقاب	Checked in reliable sources
Figures, dates and units	الأرقام والتواريخ والوحدات	Checked twice
Attribution	الإسناد	Every claim has a source
Reporting verbs	أفعال القول	Same stance as the source
Headline and lead	العنوان والمقدمة	Target conventions
Length and timing	الطول والمدة	Respect the brief

Warm-up: think and discuss

1 Which steps of the newsroom chain have you practised in this chapter?

2 What would you cut first if your bulletin were 30 seconds too long?

3 How will you share terminology decisions within your team?

Headline workshop

Translate each headline into the other language. Respect the headline conventions of the target language (maximum 10 words).

#	Source headline	Your translation
1	قمة مجموعة العشرين تعتمد إعلانها رغم المقاطعة الأمريكية	
2	كوب 30 يختتم أعماله من دون خريطة طريق للوقود الأحفوري	
3	محادثات أمريكية أوكرانية في جنيف بشأن خطة السلام	
4	البابا لاوُن يستعد لزيارة تركيا ولبنان	
5	Syria one year after Assad: how did we get here?	
6	Africa hosts G20 summit for the first time	

MEDIA WATCH

Before the session, record one complete evening bulletin in Arabic and in English on the same day. Bring a list of the items and their order to class.

Texts: two extended passages

Translate each full text as a professional task: define the brief, build a mini-termbase, draft, revise, and note your decisions in the log.

Brief: Translate and transedit this Arabic weekend bulletin into a 90-second English radio bulletin for an international station. You may reorder and condense, but every claim must keep its source.

TEXT 1 — **Arabic → English** · Media and Politics · Full radio bulletin (four items)

في جوهانسبرغ، اعتمد قادة مجموعة العشرين إعلانهم الختامي منذ افتتاح القمة، في سابقة خالفت العرف المتّبع، وذلك رغم مقاطعة الولايات المتحدة لأول قمة للمجموعة تُعقد في القارة الأفريقية. وقال الرئيس الجنوبي الأفريقي سيريل رامافوزا إن الإعلان يثبت أن العمل متعدد الأطراف «قادر على تحقيق النتائج»، فيما أعلنت الأرجنتين أنها لا تؤيد النص.

وفي البرازيل، اختُتم مؤتمر الأمم المتحدة للمناخ «كوب 30» في مدينة بيليم باتفاق يدعو إلى مضاعفة تمويل التكيّف ثلاث مرات بحلول عام 2035، لكن النص النهائي خلا من أي إشارة إلى الوقود الأحفوري، ما أثار خيبة أمل دول عديدة.

وفي جنيف، يجتمع اليوم وفدان أمريكي وأوكراني لمناقشة خطة أمريكية من ثمانية وعشرين بندًا لإنهاء الحرب في أوكرانيا، وسط تحفظات أوروبية على بعض بنودها.

وأخيرًا، يستعد البابا لاوُن الرابع عشر لأول رحلة خارجية له منذ انتخابه، تشمل تركيا ولبنان في أواخر الشهر الجاري، في زيارة يُنتظر أن تحمل رسائل حول السلام والحوار بين الأديان.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of an Arabic radio bulletin, based on publicly reported events (22–23 November 2025). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

Your translation

English bulletin headlines menu (two lines):

Brief: Translate this explainer for the website of an Arabic satellite channel. Keep the chronological structure; use dates in the format «8 ديسمبر/كانون الأول» as required by the channel's style guide.

TEXT 2

English → Arabic · Media and Politics · Explainer timeline (Syria)

Syria one year after Assad: how did we get here? On 8 December 2024, opposition forces led by Hayat Tahrir al-Sham entered Damascus and Bashar al-Assad fled the country, ending more than five decades of rule by his family. In January 2025, Ahmed al-Sharaa was named interim president, and in March he signed a constitutional declaration setting a five-year transitional period.

The transition has been marked by outbreaks of deadly violence, on the coast in March and in Sweida in July. On the international stage, however, Damascus has made rapid progress: in May, President Trump announced that US sanctions would be lifted, and in November Mr al-Sharaa became the first Syrian president to visit the White House.

Indirect parliamentary elections were held in October, and more than a million refugees have returned, according to the UN refugee agency. Yet many Syrians still face destroyed homes, a shattered economy and deep uncertainty about the future.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of an English-language explainer, based on publicly reported events (December 2024 – November 2025). Not a broadcaster's script; details simplified for training.

Your translation

Arabic title (maximum 10 words):

Commentary on your decisions

TRANSLATOR'S LOG

Final portfolio commentary (300 words): describe the decisions your team made about selection, order, terminology and attribution in Text 1 and Text 2, and evaluate the result against the brief.

Media and Politics Word Lists

English–Arabic terms used in this chapter (verify against current sources before use)

MEDIA AND NEWS TERMS

headline	عنوان رئيسي	analysis	تحليل
strapline / subheading	عنوان فرعي	explainer	مقال تفسيري
lead (intro)	مقدمة الخبر	live coverage	تغطية مباشرة
dateline	سطر المكان والتاريخ	footage	لقطات مصوّرة
news agency	وكالة أنباء	eyewitness	شاهد عيان
wire report / dispatch	برقية إخبارية	unconfirmed reports	تقارير غير مؤكدة
news bulletin	نشرة أخبار	to verify	يتحقق من
anchor / newsreader	مذيع / مقدّم النشرة	misinformation	معلومات مضللة
correspondent	مراسل	according to	بحسب / وفقًا لـ
breaking news	خبر عاجل	to quote	يقتبس / ينقل عن
press conference	مؤتمر صحفي	to deny	ينفي
spokesperson	متحدث رسمي	to confirm	يؤكد
state media	وسائل الإعلام الرسمية	transediting	التحرير الترجمي
editorial	افتتاحية	style guide	دليل الأسلوب
column	عمود صحفي	voice-over	تعليق صوتي
op-ed	مقال رأي	subtitles	ترجمة مكتوبة على الشاشة

POLITICS, DIPLOMACY AND CONFLICT TERMS

indirect talks	محادثات غير مباشرة	Security Council	مجلس الأمن
round of negotiations	جولة مفاوضات	resolution	قرار
mediation	وساطة	abstention	امتناع عن التصويت
memorandum of understanding	مذكرة تفاهم	veto	حق النقض (الفيتو)
ceasefire / truce	وقف إطلاق النار / هدنة	summit	قمة
de-escalation	خفض التصعيد	joint statement	بيان مشترك
escalation	تصعيد	delegation	وفد
sanctions	عقوبات	envoy	مبعوث
naval blockade	حصار بحري	general election	انتخابات عامة
strait	مضيق	midterm elections	الانتخابات النصفية
airstrike	غارة جوية	coalition	ائتلاف
retaliation	رد انتقامي	turnout	نسبة المشاركة
drone	طائرة مسيّرة	displaced persons	نازحون
ballistic missile	صاروخ باليستي	refugees	لاجئون
uranium enrichment	تخصيب اليورانيوم	humanitarian corridor	ممر إنساني
nuclear facility	منشأة نووية	death toll	حصيلة القتلى

My Termbase

Record every term you research: concept, equivalent, source, context

English term	Arabic equivalent	Source	Context and notes

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STYLE GUIDES AND TERMINOLOGY RESOURCES (CONSULT THE LATEST ONLINE VERSIONS)

BBC News style guide; Reuters handbook of journalism; Associated Press stylebook.

United Nations: UNTERM (multilingual terminology database), UN Digital Library and the Arabic versions of Security Council resolutions.

IATE (EU terminology database); websites of UN agencies in Arabic and English (UN News, UNHCR, WFP, IMO).